

ENGLISH FOR HOSPITALITY AND TOURISM

Hospitality & Tourism English

Welcome warmly. Resolve clearly.
Coordinate precisely.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For hotel, resort, venue, and tour professionals working with guests and colleagues.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight service conversations: welcome an early arrival, answer a complaint, offer accommodation alternatives, explain room revenue, coordinate a room release, confirm an event schedule, update a disrupted tour, and clarify an individual preference.

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Hospitality without uncertain promises

Good service combines warmth with accurate information. Say what is confirmed, explain the available options, and take responsibility for the next communication. Keep internal shorthand out of guest-facing explanations.

Acknowledge before correcting

Recognize the inconvenience, then explain the relevant facts. An explanation that starts by blaming the guest can make a solvable problem harder to resolve.

"I can see why that message suggested the room would be ready. Let me clarify what we can confirm."

Promise the action you control

A check with another department and a guest update are actions you can own. A repair completion, room release, or tour departure may depend on a separate decision.

"I will update you at one o'clock, even if the room is still awaiting release."

Translate operational language

Terms such as walk, release, and room inventory have specialist meanings. Use them precisely with colleagues and explain the practical outcome to guests.

"We can arrange the confirmed room at the nearby hotel, with the agreed transfer included."

Ask about the individual

A preference about timing, beds, conversation, or service frequency belongs to the guest. Nationality does not establish the reason or the preferred response.

"Would you prefer service after two today, or no service today?"

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All properties, people, figures, and policies in the cases are fictional. This book teaches workplace language, not legal advice or safety procedures. Follow current local rules, approved service policies, privacy requirements, and operator emergency plans. Do not treat an exercise as operational authorization.

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

A Read the situation

Acknowledge an expectation gap and give a reliable next step without inventing a room-ready time.

Ms Vega arrives at 12:15. Her confirmation says that her early-arrival request has been noted, but she understood this as guaranteed access at noon. Standard check-in begins at 15:00. No room has yet been released, and the front desk has no verified room-ready time. Complimentary luggage storage and use of the lobby seating are available now. Front-desk agent Arun can check with housekeeping and give a personal update at 13:00 even if the status has not changed. He cannot guarantee an earlier room or authorize compensation on his own.

PEOPLE / Arun: Front-desk agent | Ms Vega: Arriving guest

SERVICE LANGUAGE CAN CREATE A COMMITMENT

Noted, requested, and confirmed can sound interchangeable to a tired traveler. Explain their difference without treating the guest as foolish. A calm apology for unclear communication can sit beside an honest limit on what is currently available.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What did the confirmation establish?

- A The early-arrival request was recorded.
- B A room was guaranteed at noon.
- C The guest had canceled her booking.
- D Compensation had been approved.

2. What can Arun provide now?

- A A guaranteed 13:00 room
- B Complimentary luggage storage and lobby seating
- C A released room
- D An approved refund

3. What does the 13:00 commitment concern?

- A The start of standard check-in
- B A personal status update
- C Guaranteed room entry
- D Completion of every room inspection

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

early arrival

Arrival before the standard check-in period.

IN USE note an early arrival

early check-in

Access to a room before the usual check-in time.

IN USE request early check-in

reservation confirmation

A message documenting a booking and its stated terms.

IN USE review the reservation confirmation

special request

A preference or need submitted with a booking.

IN USE record a special request

guaranteed access

A confirmed commitment that entry will be available.

IN USE distinguish guaranteed access

subject to availability

Dependent on whether the requested service is available.

IN USE explain subject to availability

front desk

The guest reception and service point.

IN USE contact the front desk

guest relations

The function handling guest experience and concerns.

IN USE refer to guest relations

duty manager

The manager responsible during a particular shift.

IN USE consult the duty manager

arrival time

The time a guest reaches the property.

IN USE confirm the arrival time

check-in window

The stated period when check-in begins or is expected.

IN USE clarify the check-in window

room assignment

Allocation of a particular room to a booking.

IN USE confirm a room assignment

Precision check

The recorded request is not a confirmed noon check-in. The 13:00 update is a communication commitment, not a room-release estimate. Standard check-in begins at 15:00; Arun should not invent a different guaranteed time.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

room-ready time

The time a room is expected or confirmed to be available.

IN USE verify the room-ready time

room release

Authorization to make a prepared room available for use.

IN USE await room release

luggage storage

A service holding bags before or after room use.

IN USE offer luggage storage

claim ticket

A receipt used to identify stored belongings.

IN USE issue a claim ticket

complimentary

Supplied without an additional charge.

IN USE offer a complimentary service

lobby

The main public reception area.

IN USE use the lobby seating

status update

A report on the current position of a request.

IN USE provide a status update

expectation gap

A difference between anticipated and actual service.

IN USE acknowledge an expectation gap

service recovery

Action to address a disappointing service experience.

IN USE coordinate service recovery

authorization limit

The boundary of what an employee may approve.

IN USE respect an authorization limit

escalation

Referral to a person with relevant responsibility or authority.

IN USE explain the escalation

follow-through

Completion of an action that was promised.

IN USE ensure reliable follow-through

Precision check

Complimentary luggage storage does not imply compensation, a free upgrade, or automatic room access. Describe exactly what is available. If a remedy needs a manager, distinguish requesting approval from obtaining it.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE IMPACT

"I understand that you planned around arriving at noon."

CLARIFY THE RECORD

"The message records your request for early access."

STATE THE CURRENT POSITION

"No room has been released yet."

OFFER IMMEDIATE HELP

"We can store your luggage at no additional charge."

OWN UNCLEAR WORDING

"I am sorry the confirmation did not make that distinction clear."

SEPARATE CONFIRMATION

"It does not confirm that a room is ready at noon."

AVOID AN INVENTED ESTIMATE

"I do not have a verified room-ready time."

OFFER A PLACE TO WAIT

"You are welcome to use the lobby seating."

Noted

Means recorded; it does not necessarily mean approved.

Ready

Use only when the relevant room status is confirmed.

At no additional charge

Explains complimentary in plain guest-facing language.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

TAKE THE NEXT ACTION

"I will check the status with housekeeping."

PRESERVE THE DISTINCTION

"That is an update time, not a promise of room access."

AVOID PASSING BLAME

"Let me clarify the wording and the available options."

CHECK THE GUEST'S PREFERENCE

"Would you like us to store your bags now?"

SET THE UPDATE TIME

"I will speak with you again at 13:00."

EXPLAIN THE NORMAL TIMING

"Standard check-in begins at 15:00."

RESPECT APPROVAL LIMITS

"A compensation request needs the duty manager's review."

CLOSE THE LOOP

"I will update you even if the status has not changed."

By versus at

By sets a latest time; at names the planned moment.

I will check

Commits to an action, not to a favorable result.

Even if

Makes the update commitment independent of a status change.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which reply handles the misunderstanding best?

- A** I see why you expected noon access; the request was recorded, but no room is released yet.
- B** You should have understood the wording.
- C** Your room will certainly be ready in ten minutes.
- D** Housekeeping always causes this problem.

2. Which promise is within Arun's stated control?

- A** The room will be ready at 13:00.
- B** I guarantee an upgrade.
- C** I have approved a refund.
- D** I will update you at 13:00 even if we are still waiting.

3. Which statement accurately explains complimentary storage?

- A** Your whole stay is now free.
- B** You must accept storage instead of a room.
- C** Storage guarantees immediate room access.
- D** We can hold your luggage without an additional charge.

4. What should Arun do if compensation is requested?

- A** Promise approval before checking.
- B** Delete the booking to remove the dispute.
- C** Say no manager can ever consider it.
- D** Refer the request for the duty manager's review.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

An early-arrival request sounded like a promise

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

duty manager / review / frustration / early-arrival request / claim ticket / complimentary / status update / follow-through / front desk / room-ready time

- 01 **Ms Vega:** I asked to arrive at noon, and your email said it was noted. It is already twelve fifteen. I expected to go straight to my room.
- 02 **Arun:** I understand your ¹ _____, and I am sorry the message was unclear. Let me check the room status and explain what we can arrange now.
- 03 **Ms Vega:** I have been traveling since early this morning. I would have planned differently if I had known I might be waiting.
- 04 **Arun:** Your ² _____ is in the booking record. It asked for noon access, but that access was not confirmed. Standard check-in begins at three this afternoon.
- 05 **Ms Vega:** Is there no possibility of a room before three? Should I leave and return later?
- 06 **Arun:** I cannot rule out earlier availability, but I do not have a verified ³ _____. No room has been released yet, so I should not give you an estimate as a promise.
- 07 **Ms Vega:** Another hotel promised twenty minutes, and I waited nearly two hours. I would prefer an honest answer to another guess.
- 08 **Arun:** That is reasonable. I can offer ⁴ _____ luggage storage now, and you may use the lobby seating. I will also check directly with housekeeping rather than leave your request without a follow-up.
- 09 **Ms Vega:** Please store the bags. I still need to decide whether to get something to eat nearby. How will I know whether anything has changed?
- 10 **Arun:** I will give you a personal ⁵ _____ at one o'clock. That update will happen even if we are still waiting. One o'clock is not a confirmed time for entering the room.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Ms Vega:** All right. I will stay in the lobby until then. Please do not send me to several departments to ask the same question again.
- 12 **Arun:** You can come back to me at the ⁶ _____. I will coordinate the check with housekeeping and tell you the result, so you do not need to repeat the request elsewhere.
- 13 **Ms Vega:** Please also review that email. It sounded as though my early arrival had been approved.
- 14 **Arun:** I will pass that concern to the ⁷ _____. I can describe the wording you received and the expectation it created, without suggesting that you caused the misunderstanding.
- 15 **Ms Vega:** Would the manager be able to consider some compensation for the inconvenience? I understand that you may not be the person who can decide.
- 16 **Arun:** I can submit that for ⁸ _____, but I cannot promise the outcome. For now, the confirmed arrangements are luggage storage, lobby seating, and my update at one o'clock.
- 17 **Ms Vega:** That is clear. I will hand over the bags now, and I will look for you here at one. Please update me even without good news.
- 18 **Arun:** I will. Once the bags are stored, I will give you a ⁹ _____ for collecting them. Please keep it with you, and let me know if you need something from the luggage while you wait.
- 19 **Ms Vega:** Thank you. I will wait here until one, then decide about lunch. Please come and find me even if the room is still not ready.
- 20 **Arun:** I will take care of the ¹⁰ _____: check with housekeeping, pass on your concern, and find you here at one. I will distinguish an estimate from a confirmed release.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. frustration | 2. early-arrival request | 3. room-ready time | 4. complimentary | 5. status update | 6. front desk | 7. duty manager | 8. review | 9. claim ticket | 10. follow-through

An update is not a release time

F Say it

At 11:30, no room is released. Free luggage storage is confirmed. The agent commits to an update at 12:00 but has no verified access time.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

room access / luggage / update / complimentary

Guest: "Is noon a guaranteed time for ¹ _____?"

Agent: "No; noon is the time for my ² _____."

Guest: "Can you hold my ³ _____ while I wait?"

Agent: "Yes, that service is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. room access | 2. update | 3. luggage | 4. complimentary

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the completed conversation in pairs, keeping the apology warm and direct.
2. Repeat turns 9-12 and 17-20; stress one as the update time, not the room-access time.
3. Switch roles for the transfer, explaining complimentary in a natural guest-facing tone.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A public reply should not become a public argument

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a complaint, protect booking details, and move investigation to the appropriate private channel.

Guest-relations agent Elise reviews a draft reply to a public complaint about late-night noise. The draft accuses the guest of exaggerating and includes the room number, stay dates, and booking reference. The complaint has not yet been checked against the property records. Manager Mateo requires a brief, courteous public acknowledgement and an invitation to contact the property through its published guest-relations channel. The private review will verify relevant records before any remedy is decided. Any approved remedy must be independent of whether the guest edits or removes the review.

PEOPLE / Elise: Guest-relations agent | Mateo: Guest-services manager

A REPLY HAS MORE THAN ONE READER

A public response speaks to the reviewer and to future guests. Firmly correcting a verified fact may sometimes be appropriate, but arguing about an unverified account or revealing private details damages trust. Keep investigation and personal booking discussion in the approved private channel.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is established about the noise complaint?

- A Every detail has been verified.
- B A refund has already been approved.
- C It has been reported but not yet checked.
- D It has been disproved.

2. Which information should be removed from the public draft?

- A A courteous acknowledgement
- B The published guest-relations channel
- C A brief invitation to contact the property
- D Room number, stay dates, and booking reference

3. What may an approved remedy depend on here?

- A Removal of the review
- B A five-star replacement review
- C Public praise for the manager
- D The outcome of the service review and applicable policy

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

public reply

A response visible to other readers of a review.

IN USE publish a public reply

reviewer

A person who posts an account or evaluation.

IN USE acknowledge the reviewer

guest feedback

Information guests provide about their experience.

IN USE respond to guest feedback

noise complaint

A report of unwanted or disruptive sound.

IN USE investigate a noise complaint

service lapse

A failure to provide an expected service standard.

IN USE verify a service lapse

acknowledgement

Recognition that a concern has been received.

IN USE give a courteous acknowledgement

defensive tone

Language focused on protecting oneself from criticism.

IN USE remove a defensive tone

personal attack

Criticism directed at the person rather than the issue.

IN USE avoid personal attacks

booking reference

An identifier for a particular reservation.

IN USE protect the booking reference

stay dates

The dates covered by a guest's visit.

IN USE verify stay dates privately

private channel

A communication route not open to public readers.

IN USE use the approved private channel

published contact details

Official contact information available to customers.

IN USE use published contact details

Precision check

An acknowledgement is not a finding that every allegation is correct. Equally, missing verification is not proof that the guest is wrong. The public reply should not announce the result of a review that has not occurred.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

case record

The controlled account of a complaint and its handling.

IN USE update the case record

complaint handler

The person responsible for progressing a concern.

IN USE assign a complaint handler

factual check

Verification of a claim against relevant information.

IN USE complete a factual check

incident log

A record of reported events and actions.

IN USE consult the incident log

service remedy

An action offered to address a service problem.

IN USE authorize a service remedy

goodwill gesture

A discretionary offer intended to repair a relationship.

IN USE consider a goodwill gesture

conditional offer

An offer dependent on a stated condition.

IN USE reject an improper conditional offer

review incentive

A benefit offered to influence a review.

IN USE avoid a review incentive

reputational risk

The possibility of damage to public trust.

IN USE reduce reputational risk

response template

A reusable structure for a written reply.

IN USE adapt a response template

unverified allegation

A claim not yet established through checking.

IN USE distinguish an unverified allegation

resolution status

The current position of a complaint outcome.

IN USE report the resolution status

Precision check

Do not condition compensation or a goodwill gesture on deleting, revising, or improving a public review. Resolve the service issue under the applicable policy and keep the guest free to describe their experience.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

RECOGNIZE THE CONCERN

"Thank you for raising your concern about the noise."

AVOID A PREMATURE FINDING

"We would like to review the details with you."

OFFER A PRIVATE ROUTE

"Please contact our published guest-relations channel."

DESCRIBE THE CURRENT STATUS

"The complaint has not yet been checked."

ACKNOWLEDGE DISAPPOINTMENT

"I am sorry to hear that your stay was disappointing."

PROTECT THE BOOKING

"Please do not post your booking information publicly."

REMOVE THE ATTACK

"That sentence challenges the guest's character, not the facts."

REQUEST RELEVANT EVIDENCE

"Let us review the incident log and relevant records."

Reports

Attributes an account without declaring it proved or false.

Sorry to hear

Expresses concern without asserting an unverified cause.

Review the details

Names a process, not a guaranteed result.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME RESPONSIBILITY

"I will be the contact for the private review."

KEEP THE REPLY CONCISE

"The public response needs acknowledgement and a next step."

AVOID A PREMATURE REMEDY

"No compensation decision has been made."

KEEP THE REMEDY SEPARATE

"Any remedy will not depend on changing the review."

REJECT A CONDITION

"We cannot offer a benefit in exchange for removing it."

USE NEUTRAL WORDING

"The guest reports late-night noise."

RECORD THE OUTCOME

"Update the case record after the review is complete."

CLOSE PROFESSIONALLY

"We welcome the opportunity to follow up directly."

Privately

Concerns the channel; still apply the approved access rules.

In exchange for

Signals a condition linking the benefit to the review.

Resolved

Use only when the relevant outcome and status support it.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which public reply is most appropriate?

- A** Our investigation proves you are wrong, although we have not checked.
- B** We are sorry to hear about the noise concern; please contact our published guest-relations channel so we can review it.
- C** Your room number proves that you are exaggerating.
- D** Delete the review and we will consider helping.

2. Which internal note is suitably neutral?

- A** The guest is dishonest.
- B** The noise definitely never happened.
- C** The complaint is resolved because we replied.
- D** The guest reports late-night noise; verification is pending.

3. Which proposal should be rejected?

- A** Check the incident log.
- B** Remove booking details from the public response.
- C** Assign a private follow-up contact.
- D** Offer a credit only if the guest removes the review.

4. What does posting the public reply establish?

- A** The investigation is complete.
- B** A refund is approved.
- C** The guest has accepted a settlement.
- D** The concern has received an acknowledgement and a next step.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

A public reply should not become a public argument

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

public reply / conditional offer / case record / acknowledgement / resolution status / incident log / booking reference / guest feedback / service remedy / defensive tone

- 01 **Elise:** Could you check my response to the noise review before I publish it? I was frustrated by the guest's description.
- 02 **Mateo:** Let us start with the ¹ _____. It will be read by future guests as well. We need a calm acknowledgement and a useful next step, not an argument.
- 03 **Elise:** I included the room number and stay dates to show that we know the booking. I also said the guest exaggerated what happened that night.
- 04 **Mateo:** Remove the ² _____ and the other private details. Knowing the reservation does not justify publishing it. Have we actually checked the complaint against the relevant property records yet?
- 05 **Elise:** No, not yet. I used the original complaint and my colleague's impression of the conversation. That is not enough to establish whether the reported noise occurred.
- 06 **Mateo:** Then describe it as ³ _____ awaiting review. Do not call the account false, and do not claim that we have already proved a service failure. Neither conclusion is established.
- 07 **Elise:** Could the reply say that we are sorry to hear the stay was disappointing, then invite the guest to contact our published guest-relations channel?
- 08 **Mateo:** Yes. That provides an ⁴ _____ without announcing an investigation result. Keep it brief, and make the next step easy to find. We do not need to reconstruct the stay in public.
- 09 **Elise:** I will take that sentence out. Could you check the new wording after I remove the booking details as well?
- 10 **Mateo:** Exactly. That ⁵ _____ makes a factual conversation harder. We can explain relevant verified information later, but first we need a proper review and a clear person responsible.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Elise:** I can handle the follow-up. Once the guest contacts us privately, I will confirm the necessary booking information through our approved process and review the available records.
- 12 **Mateo:** Consult the ⁶ _____ as part of that work. Record what it supports and what remains uncertain. An absent entry alone should not become a sweeping claim that nothing happened.
- 13 **Elise:** The handover suggests a credit, but only after the review comes down. We cannot use that condition, can we?
- 14 **Mateo:** Do not make that ⁷ _____. Any approved remedy must stand independently of review removal or revision. Our task is to address the service concern, not purchase a different public account.
- 15 **Elise:** Understood. I will not promise compensation in the initial reply either. We still need to check the facts and determine what our policy permits.
- 16 **Mateo:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ has not been decided. Explain that clearly in the private conversation if asked, and avoid language that suggests approval is automatic or impossible.
- 17 **Elise:** The public version now thanks the guest for raising the noise concern, acknowledges the disappointing experience, and directs them to the published contact route for follow-up.
- 18 **Mateo:** That is suitable. After publishing, create the ⁹ _____ and identify yourself as the contact. Preserve the distinction between the public acknowledgement and the unfinished private investigation.
- 19 **Elise:** I will check the records before reaching a conclusion, then communicate any authorized outcome directly. The guest will remain free to leave the review as it is.
- 20 **Mateo:** Good. Update the ¹⁰ _____ when the review progresses. For now, mark it as awaiting private follow-up, not resolved merely because we have answered online.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. public reply | 2. booking reference | 3. guest feedback | 4. acknowledgement | 5. defensive tone | 6. incident log | 7. conditional offer | 8. service remedy | 9. case record | 10. resolution status

Resolve the service issue, not the rating

F Say it

A guest posts a complaint about a delayed airport pickup. No investigation is complete. The draft reply includes a reservation code and offers a voucher only for deleting the review.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

acknowledgement / reservation code / factual check / deletion

Manager: "Remove the ¹ _____ from the public response."

Agent: "We can give a courteous ² _____ now."

Manager: "The complaint still needs a ³ _____."

Agent: "Any approved voucher must be independent of review
⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. reservation code | 2. acknowledgement | 3. factual check | 4. deletion

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-8, separating acknowledgment of the concern from a completed investigation.
2. Repeat turns 13-16; make the rejection of a review-removal condition explicit.
3. Switch roles for the transfer and read the corrected public/private boundary aloud.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The booked room type is unavailable

A Read the situation

03

Present verified alternatives, explain differences honestly, and obtain a guest decision before changing the booking.

Mr Chen booked one king-bed room for tonight. That room type is unavailable. Duty manager Sofia has two verified alternatives: an on-site twin room with two separate beds at no additional charge, or a king-bed room at the nearby Harbor Hotel. For the off-site option, this property has approved payment of the room-price difference and a transfer; other expenses are not approved. Harbor Hotel has confirmed availability for tonight. Mr Chen has not selected an option. Sofia must explain the bed arrangements and location, check his preference, and complete the chosen arrangement before calling it confirmed.

PEOPLE / Sofia: Duty manager | Mr Chen: Guest with a king-room booking

A SUBSTITUTE IS NOT AUTOMATICALLY EQUIVALENT

Two available rooms may differ in the feature that matters most to a guest. Describe beds, location, and approved costs plainly. Internal shorthand such as walk should not replace a respectful explanation of the actual accommodation arrangement.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which alternative preserves the booked bed arrangement?

A Neither option has a confirmed bed type.

B The king room at Harbor Hotel

C The on-site twin room

D Either option has one king bed.

2. What costs are approved for the off-site option?

A Every expense during the stay

B A future holiday

C Only an unconfirmed taxi estimate

D The room-price difference and transfer

3. Has the guest accepted an alternative?

A Yes; the manager chose silently.

B No; both alternatives are unavailable.

C No; his choice is still required.

D Yes; availability means acceptance.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

room type

A category of accommodation with specified features.

IN USE verify the room type

king room

A room containing a king-size bed.

IN USE confirm a king room

twin room

A room with two separate beds.

IN USE offer a twin room

bed configuration

The number and arrangement of beds.

IN USE explain the bed configuration

overbooking

Accepting more bookings than the available capacity can accommodate.

IN USE manage an overbooking

room-type mismatch

A difference between booked and offered accommodation categories.

IN USE resolve a room-type mismatch

walk

Industry shorthand for relocating a guest to another property.

IN USE arrange a guest walk

relocation

Moving a booking or guest to another property.

IN USE explain the relocation

alternative accommodation

A substitute place to stay.

IN USE verify alternative accommodation

receiving property

The property accepting a relocated guest.

IN USE contact the receiving property

on-site

Located at the same property.

IN USE offer an on-site alternative

off-site

Located away from the original property.

IN USE arrange an off-site room

Precision check

A twin room does not preserve a king-bed configuration. A king room at another hotel preserves that feature but changes location. Neither alternative should be called identical to the original booking.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

availability check

Verification that a room or service can be supplied.

IN USE complete an availability check

rate difference

The difference between the two room prices.

IN USE cover the rate difference

transfer

Transport between locations.

IN USE arrange the approved transfer

incidental expense

An additional cost outside the basic room arrangement.

IN USE clarify incidental expenses

approved allowance

A specifically authorized amount or type of support.

IN USE state the approved allowance

guest consent

The guest's agreement to the proposed arrangement.

IN USE obtain guest consent

booking amendment

A documented change to an existing reservation.

IN USE confirm a booking amendment

confirmation number

An identifier for a confirmed booking.

IN USE verify the confirmation number

arrival instructions

Directions for reaching or entering the receiving property.

IN USE provide arrival instructions

handover contact

The person coordinating the receiving end of an arrangement.

IN USE identify the handover contact

service commitment

A specific promise made about the service provided.

IN USE document the service commitment

equivalent feature

A characteristic that genuinely matches the original requirement.

IN USE check equivalent features

Precision check

Availability, guest agreement, and completion of the replacement booking are separate stages. Approval to cover a price difference and transfer is not an unlimited promise to pay all incidental expenses.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE PROBLEM DIRECTLY

"Your booked king-room type is unavailable tonight."

INTRODUCE CHOICES

"I have two verified alternatives to explain."

CLARIFY THE CHARGE

"There would be no additional room charge for that option."

NAME THE DIFFERENCE

"That keeps the bed type but changes the location."

ACKNOWLEDGE RESPONSIBILITY

"I am sorry we cannot provide the room type you reserved."

DESCRIBE THE ON-SITE OPTION

"We have a twin room here with two separate beds."

DESCRIBE THE OFF-SITE OPTION

"Harbor Hotel has confirmed a king room for tonight."

EXPLAIN APPROVED COSTS

"We will cover the room-price difference and the transfer."

Available

Does not mean already booked in this guest's name.

Included

Specify exactly what the package includes.

Equivalent

Avoid when a material feature or location differs.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

BOUND THE OFFER

"Other expenses are not included in the approved arrangement."

AVOID ASSUMING AGREEMENT

"I have not changed your booking without your choice."

COMPLETE THE HANDOVER

"I will confirm the booking and arrival details."

USE PLAIN LANGUAGE

"We can arrange accommodation at the nearby hotel."

ASK WHAT MATTERS

"Is the king bed or staying at this property more important?"

CHECK THE SELECTION

"Would you like me to arrange the Harbor Hotel option?"

KEEP TIMING ACCURATE

"I still need to confirm the transfer arrangements."

CLOSE WITH A READBACK

"Let me repeat the room, location, and costs we have agreed."

Walk

Internal jargon; explain relocation plainly to the guest.

Would you like

Requests a choice rather than assuming agreement.

Confirmed

Identify which part of the arrangement is confirmed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which description is most accurate?

- A** The twin room is identical to a king room.
- B** The king room is on-site.
- C** Both alternatives change only the price.
- D** The twin room is on-site but has two separate beds.

2. Which statement overpromises?

- A** I need your choice before completing the change.
- B** We will pay every expense you incur.
- C** The approved offer covers the price difference and transfer.
- D** Harbor Hotel has a king room available tonight.

3. What should happen before changing the booking?

- A** Explain the alternatives and obtain the guest's choice.
- B** Select the cheaper alternative without asking.
- C** Mark both hotels as occupied by the guest.
- D** Announce that every detail is complete.

4. Which handover is complete in principle?

- A** Promise unspecified costs later.
- B** Verify the chosen booking, receiving contact, arrival details, and approved transfer.
- C** Send the guest away with only a hotel name.
- D** Treat room availability as a confirmed transfer.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The booked room type is unavailable

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

receiving property / rate difference / twin room / consent / room type / booking amendment / readback / arrival instructions / transfer / relocation

- 01 **Mr Chen:** I reserved a king room; two separate beds do not suit us. The receptionist mentioned a problem. What is available?
- 02 **Sofia:** I am sorry. Your booked ¹ _____ is unavailable tonight. I have two verified alternatives, and I want to explain the differences before you choose either one.
- 03 **Mr Chen:** Please start with the option here. We would prefer not to move unless staying means losing the bed arrangement that we specifically booked.
- 04 **Sofia:** The on-site option is a ² _____ with two separate beds, at no additional charge. It keeps you at this property, but it does not match your king-bed preference.
- 05 **Mr Chen:** That difference matters to us. What is the second option, and have you actually checked that the other hotel can provide the right room tonight?
- 06 **Sofia:** The ³ _____ is Harbor Hotel nearby. They have confirmed that a king room is available tonight. That preserves the bed type, although it changes where you will stay.
- 07 **Mr Chen:** Would I have to pay the difference? I do not want to arrive there and discover that this solution costs more than the booking I made.
- 08 **Sofia:** Our approved arrangement covers the ⁴ _____ and the transfer to Harbor Hotel. Other expenses are not included. I will make that scope clear in the arrangements rather than leave you with an open-ended promise.
- 09 **Mr Chen:** The king room sounds better for us. Before you arrange it, please confirm we would not pay extra for the room or the transfer.
- 10 **Sofia:** Yes. I need your ⁵ _____ before completing the change. I have not treated the availability check as your acceptance or amended the booking without asking you.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Mr Chen:** Then we choose the king room at Harbor Hotel for tonight. Please confirm the actual reservation before we leave with the luggage.
- 12 **Sofia:** I will complete the ⁶ _____ and coordinate with Harbor Hotel. I will check the room, arrival details, and payment arrangements so the receiving team has the same information.
- 13 **Mr Chen:** A member of staff used the word walk earlier. Does that mean we are expected to walk there with our bags? That would be difficult.
- 14 **Sofia:** No. That is internal shorthand for ⁷ _____. In your case, the approved offer includes transport. I should have explained the arrangement in ordinary language instead of leaving that term unclear.
- 15 **Mr Chen:** Do you have a transport departure time yet? Should we stay by reception or wait somewhere else?
- 16 **Sofia:** I still need to confirm the ⁸ _____ details. Please remain by reception while I coordinate them. I will not describe a departure time as confirmed until the transport arrangement is verified.
- 17 **Mr Chen:** That is fine. Before we leave, please give us the receiving contact and explain what we should show when we arrive at Harbor Hotel.
- 18 **Sofia:** I will provide the ⁹ _____ once the booking is completed. They will identify the receiving contact and booking details, with the agreed room-price and transfer arrangements clearly recorded.
- 19 **Mr Chen:** Could you put those details in writing? I do not want to explain the price and transport agreement again at Harbor Hotel.
- 20 **Sofia:** Certainly. First, a quick ¹⁰ _____: a king room at Harbor Hotel tonight, price difference and transfer covered, other expenses excluded. I will complete the arrangements and confirm them in writing before you leave.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. room type | 2. twin room | 3. receiving property | 4. rate difference | 5. consent | 6. booking amendment | 7. relocation | 8. transfer | 9. arrival instructions | 10. readback

A feature match still needs agreement

F Say it

A guest booked a king bed. The local room has two singles. A nearby hotel has a verified king room; the approved offer covers its price difference and transport only.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bed configuration / king bed / booking / transport

Agent: "The local option has a different ¹ _____."

Guest: "The nearby option preserves the ² _____."

Agent: "Our offer includes the price difference and ³ _____."

Guest: "Please confirm the details before changing my ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. bed configuration | 2. king bed | 3. transport | 4. booking

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-8, contrasting two separate beds with a king bed without calling them equivalent.
2. Repeat turns 13-20, explaining walk in ordinary language and reading back the included costs.
3. Switch roles for the transfer and emphasize the feature that each option preserves or changes.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

04

A Read the situation

Explain occupancy, average daily rate, and revenue per available room using the correct denominators.

Revenue analyst Mina reviews two single-night results with general manager Owen. Each night had 100 available rooms. On Night A, 80 rooms sold and room revenue was \$8,000. On Night B, 60 rooms sold and room revenue was \$7,200. These figures exclude non-room revenue; no cost figures are supplied. Owen calls the higher average daily rate a complete commercial improvement. Mina needs to distinguish the higher rate among sold rooms from the lower occupancy and lower revenue per available room. The two observations alone do not establish why demand changed.

PEOPLE / Mina: Revenue analyst | Owen: General manager

CHALLENGE THE MEASURE, NOT THE PERSON

A manager may use a familiar headline as shorthand for success. Name the calculation and its boundary before disagreeing with the conclusion. A precise comparison lets the team discuss pricing without turning a useful challenge into a contest over confidence.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Night B's average daily rate?

A \$120

B \$72

C \$60

D \$100

2. What is Night B's revenue per available room?

A \$7,200

B \$72

C \$120

D \$80

3. What cannot be calculated from the supplied figures?

A Profit

B Occupancy

C Average daily rate

D Room revenue per available room

Answers and explanations: page 91.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

average daily rate (ADR)

Room revenue divided by rooms sold for the period.

IN USE calculate average daily rate

occupancy rate

Rooms sold as a percentage of rooms available.

IN USE report the occupancy rate

revenue per available room (RevPAR)

Room revenue divided by available room supply.

IN USE compare revenue per available room

room revenue

Revenue from selling guest rooms.

IN USE distinguish room revenue

rooms sold

The count of paid room units sold in the stated period.

IN USE verify rooms sold

rooms available

Room supply available for the stated reporting period.

IN USE state rooms available

room night

One room for one night.

IN USE measure demand in room nights

non-room revenue

Revenue from services other than room sales.

IN USE separate non-room revenue

revenue management

Coordinating price and availability to manage revenue.

IN USE review revenue management

rate strategy

The approach used to set and vary selling prices.

IN USE evaluate the rate strategy

demand

Customer willingness and ability to purchase accommodation.

IN USE assess room demand

booking pace

The speed at which reservations accumulate for a date.

IN USE track booking pace

Precision check

Night A: occupancy 80%, ADR \$100, RevPAR \$80. Night B: occupancy 60%, ADR \$120, RevPAR \$72. ADR increased 20%, but RevPAR and total room revenue each decreased 10%. Occupancy fell 20 percentage points.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

pickup

The change in booked business between reporting points.

IN USE report booking pickup

on-the-books

Reservations already recorded for a future period.

IN USE review on-the-books revenue

forecast occupancy

The estimated share of rooms expected to sell.

IN USE revise forecast occupancy

market segment

A defined customer or business category.

IN USE compare market segments

channel mix

The proportions sold through different booking routes.

IN USE examine the channel mix

distribution cost

The expense associated with selling through a channel.

IN USE include distribution costs

net room revenue

Room revenue after the specified deductions.

IN USE define net room revenue

gross operating profit

Operating revenue less the relevant operating expenses.

IN USE distinguish gross operating profit

competitive set

A selected group of properties used for comparison.

IN USE review the competitive set

rate premium

A price above a stated comparison rate.

IN USE explain the rate premium

price elasticity

The responsiveness of demand to price changes.

IN USE assess price elasticity

revenue trade-off

A gain in one revenue driver offset by another change.

IN USE explain a revenue trade-off

Precision check

ADR uses rooms sold; RevPAR uses rooms available. The identical supply makes the revenue comparison straightforward here. Neither room metric includes all hotel revenue or costs, and two nights do not isolate the cause of a demand change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE HEADLINE

"Which measure do we mean by improved?"

GIVE THE FIRST RESULT

"Night A sold 80 rooms for \$8,000."

EXPLAIN ADR

"Divide room revenue by rooms sold."

EXPLAIN OCCUPANCY

"Sixty of one hundred rooms sold, or 60%."

STATE THE COMMON BASE

"Both nights had 100 available rooms."

GIVE THE SECOND RESULT

"Night B sold 60 rooms for \$7,200."

REPORT THE RATE CHANGE

"ADR rose from \$100 to \$120."

USE POINTS CORRECTLY

"Occupancy fell by 20 percentage points."

Per sold room

Names the ADR denominator, not total room supply.

Per available room

Includes the whole defined supply in the denominator.

Rose by versus rose to

By gives the change; to gives the resulting value.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

EXPLAIN REVPAR

"Divide room revenue by rooms available."

STATE THE REVENUE CHANGE

"Room revenue decreased by \$800, or 10%."

KEEP THE SCOPE CLEAR

"These figures concern rooms, not all hotel revenue."

REQUEST USEFUL CONTEXT

"Let us examine demand, segments, and channel mix."

REPORT THE CAPACITY YIELD

"RevPAR fell from \$80 to \$72."

AVOID A PROFIT CLAIM

"We do not have the costs needed to calculate profit."

AVOID CAUSAL OVERREACH

"This comparison does not isolate the effect of pricing."

SUMMARIZE THE TRADE-OFF

"A higher sold-room rate coincided with fewer rooms sold."

Percentage points

Use for subtracting the two occupancy percentages.

Revenue versus profit

Revenue alone does not account for the relevant costs.

Coincided with

Reports a relationship without declaring its cause.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary is accurate?

- A** RevPAR excludes unsold available rooms.
- B** ADR rose while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue fell.
- C** Every room measure improved.
- D** Higher ADR proves higher profit.

2. Which calculation gives Night A's RevPAR?

- A** \$8,000 divided by 100
- B** \$8,000 divided by 80
- C** 80 divided by 100
- D** 100 divided by 80

3. Which occupancy change is correctly stated?

- A** A rise of 20 percentage points
- B** No change because supply stayed constant
- C** A fall of 20 percentage points
- D** A fall of 20% relative

4. Which causal claim is justified by these two nights alone?

- A** The lower occupancy proves the property was closed.
- B** None; further evidence is needed to isolate a pricing effect.
- C** The higher price caused every lost booking.
- D** Demand changes never affect occupancy.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

A higher room rate did not produce higher room revenue

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ADR / room revenue / price elasticity / channel mix / RevPAR / cost figures / trade-off / rooms available / non-room revenue / occupancy

- 01 **Owen:** Our average rate went up on the second night, so I have called it a complete commercial improvement. Is there anything missing from that summary?
- 02 **Mina:** The higher ¹ _____ is real, but it is only one measure. We should look at how many rooms sold and what the available room supply earned as well.
- 03 **Owen:** Start with the room supply. I do not want to mistake a capacity change for performance.
- 04 **Mina:** Both nights had one hundred ² _____. Night A sold eighty rooms for eight thousand dollars. Night B sold sixty rooms for seven thousand two hundred dollars. These are room-only revenue figures.
- 05 **Owen:** So the first average is one hundred dollars per sold room, and the second is one hundred and twenty. That is a twenty-percent increase.
- 06 **Mina:** Correct. Meanwhile, ³ _____ moved from eighty percent to sixty percent. That is a fall of twenty percentage points, or twenty-five percent relative to the original eighty-percent level.
- 07 **Owen:** I see the distinction. The higher rate applies to a smaller number of sold rooms. How should we describe the result across all available rooms?
- 08 **Mina:** Use ⁴ _____. Eight thousand divided by one hundred is eighty dollars. Seven thousand two hundred divided by one hundred is seventy-two dollars. The capacity-based room revenue measure fell.
- 09 **Owen:** That means an eight-dollar reduction per available room. Relative to eighty dollars, it is ten percent lower, despite the higher average selling rate.
- 10 **Mina:** Yes. Total ⁵ _____ also fell ten percent, from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred. The unchanged supply means those two percentage changes align in this comparison.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Owen:** Could we still say that profit improved because we had fewer rooms to service? Fewer occupied rooms might mean some costs were lower.
- 12 **Mina:** That is possible, but we have no ⁶ _____ here. We cannot calculate profit or assume how expenses changed. A possible cost effect should remain a question, not become a reported financial result.
- 13 **Owen:** Fair point. What about restaurant and event spending? Those could change the property's total revenue even when the room figures move in the opposite direction.
- 14 **Mina:** They could, but ⁷ _____ is not included in this comparison. We should label the scope clearly instead of using the room result as a complete measure of hotel performance.
- 15 **Owen:** Can I say the price increase caused the occupancy fall, or do we need to look at the business mix first?
- 16 **Mina:** We need more evidence. We have not established ⁸ _____ or controlled other influences on demand. Let us compare the dates, segments, and booking patterns before attributing the whole decline to price.
- 17 **Owen:** Then the next discussion should look at context rather than force a cause into the headline. Which breakdown would make that review more useful?
- 18 **Mina:** Examine market segments and ⁹ _____, alongside demand and booking pace. Keep the same period and definitions, and include relevant costs before making a profitability claim.
- 19 **Owen:** I will revise the summary to say that ADR increased while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue declined. That is less sweeping and more informative.
- 20 **Mina:** Exactly. It describes the observed ¹⁰ _____ without treating one favorable metric as the whole result. We can then investigate why it happened and whether the strategy should change.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. ADR | 2. rooms available | 3. occupancy | 4. RevPAR | 5. room revenue | 6. cost figures | 7. non-room revenue | 8. price elasticity | 9. channel mix | 10. trade-off

Choose the right denominator

F Say it

A hotel has 50 available rooms for one night. It sells 40 rooms and receives \$6,000 in room revenue. No costs or non-room revenue are supplied.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

120 / profit / 150 / 80

Analyst: "Occupancy is ¹ _____ percent."

Manager: "ADR is ² _____ dollars."

Analyst: "RevPAR is ³ _____ dollars."

Manager: "We cannot calculate ⁴ _____ from these figures alone."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 80 | 2. 150 | 3. 120 | 4. profit

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 3-10, stating whether each calculation uses rooms sold or rooms available.
2. Repeat turns 11-16, separating revenue, profit, and a causal claim about pricing.
3. Switch roles for the transfer and read 80%, \$150, and \$120 with their units.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Clean does not yet mean released

A Read the situation

Read back separate department statuses and keep a room unavailable until the required release is recorded.

Room 417 is cleaned and inspected by housekeeping, but its door-lock repair is still open in the maintenance record. The fictional property requires both housekeeping clearance and maintenance clearance before the duty manager releases a room to reception. Neither maintenance clearance nor the final release is recorded for 417. Reception wants to assign it to an arriving guest. Room 419 has both clearances and a recorded release; its room type and the guest-required features have been checked and match. Reception can assign 419 without changing 417 to available or promising when its repair will finish.

PEOPLE / Leah: Reception supervisor | Marco: Rooms-division coordinator

DEPARTMENT LABELS ANSWER DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

Clean, repaired, inspected, and available may belong to separate checks. A colleague who insists on reading each status is protecting the handover, not criticizing another team. State the missing authorization and the ready alternative without blaming an entire department.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is missing for Room 417?

- A Maintenance clearance and final release
- C A room number

- B Housekeeping inspection
- D Evidence that the guest arrived

2. Which room can reception assign on the supplied facts?

- A Room 419
- C Either room because both are clean

- B Room 417
- D Neither room because no room type was checked

3. Who performs the final release in this fictional process?

- A Whoever sees a clean bed first
- C Any guest

- B The duty manager
- D The reservation website

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

room turnover

Preparing a room between guest stays.

IN USE coordinate room turnover

housekeeping clearance

Confirmation that the required housekeeping checks are complete.

IN USE record housekeeping clearance

maintenance clearance

Confirmation that the required maintenance conditions are satisfied.

IN USE obtain maintenance clearance

work order

A recorded request or instruction for maintenance work.

IN USE update a work order

open repair

A repair not yet recorded as completed and cleared.

IN USE track an open repair

door-lock fault

A reported problem with a door's locking system.

IN USE report a door-lock fault

inspection record

Documentation of a completed check and its result.

IN USE verify the inspection record

release authorization

Permission to make the room available for assignment.

IN USE verify release authorization

room status

The recorded operational condition of a room.

IN USE reconcile room status

property management system (PMS)

Software managing room, reservation, and guest operations.

IN USE update the PMS

out of order

A property-defined status taking a room out of use.

IN USE confirm an out-of-order status

out of service

A property-defined temporary unavailability status.

IN USE check the out-of-service code

Precision check

Housekeeping clearance confirms its own checks. It does not close a maintenance work order or supply the duty manager's release. For 417, keep all three statuses distinct rather than translating clean into available.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

vacant clean

A room-status label indicating an unoccupied, cleaned room.

IN USE distinguish vacant clean

vacant dirty

A room-status label indicating cleaning is still required.

IN USE report vacant dirty

occupied room

A room currently assigned for guest use.

IN USE identify an occupied room

room discrepancy

A conflict between room records or observations.

IN USE resolve a room discrepancy

engineering department

The hotel team responsible for technical maintenance.

IN USE contact the engineering department

defect report

A record describing a fault needing attention.

IN USE submit a defect report

readback

Repetition of details to check shared understanding.

IN USE request a status readback

handover log

A record used to transfer operational responsibility.

IN USE update the handover log

release hold

A restriction preventing a room from being assigned.

IN USE maintain the release hold

guest-required feature

A room characteristic needed for the particular booking.

IN USE verify guest-required features

return to service

Authorized restoration of availability after required checks.

IN USE confirm return to service

status reconciliation

Checking and resolving differences among recorded statuses.

IN USE complete status reconciliation

Precision check

Codes such as out of order and out of service vary by property and reporting system. Confirm the local definition instead of assuming a universal meaning. In this case, the explicit release process governs assignment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

NAME THE EXACT ROOM

"I am checking the release status for Room 417."

IDENTIFY THE OPEN ITEM

"The door-lock repair remains open."

KEEP THE HOLD CLEAR

"Do not assign 417 yet."

ASK FOR EVIDENCE

"Please check the clearance and release records."

SEPARATE DEPARTMENT CHECKS

"Housekeeping is cleared, but maintenance is not."

STATE THE MISSING AUTHORITY

"The duty manager's final release is not recorded."

AVOID A SHORTCUT

"Vacant clean is not the same as released under this process."

AVOID AN INVENTED DEADLINE

"I do not have a confirmed repair completion time."

Cleaned versus cleared

A physical task and a recorded authorization may be different stages.

Still open

Describes the record status without assigning blame.

Not yet

Marks a pending condition without promising when it will change.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

OFFER THE READY ALTERNATIVE

"Room 419 has both clearances and final release."

READ BACK THE ACTION

"Assign 419 and keep 417 unavailable."

USE NEUTRAL LANGUAGE

"The maintenance clearance is still pending."

REPORT THE GUEST OUTCOME

"We can accommodate the guest in the released alternative."

CONFIRM SUITABILITY

"Its room type and required features match."

KEEP RECORDS CONSISTENT

"Update the handover log without changing the repair status."

NAME THE NEXT OWNER

"The duty manager can release it after the required clearances."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Please confirm that reception has the same room status."

Released

Must refer to the relevant authorized decision.

Matches

Confirm actual required features, not only a room-category label.

Keep unavailable

Maintains the hold rather than predicting a technical outcome.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Close the repair to make the system look consistent.
- B** Promise 417 will be ready in ten minutes.
- C** Assign 419; keep 417 on hold until its required clearances and release are recorded.
- D** Assign 417 because the bed is clean.

2. What does the housekeeping inspection prove here?

- A** The lock repair is finished.
- B** The duty manager has released the room.
- C** The repair will finish before arrival.
- D** The housekeeping checks are complete.

3. Which statement about room-status codes is safest?

- A** Every property uses identical definitions.
- B** Any green screen label overrides an open repair.
- C** Out of service always means cleaned and assignable.
- D** Check the property's definitions and release rules.

4. Which response avoids blaming a team?

- A** Housekeeping caused all delays.
- B** Reception should ignore everyone else.
- C** Maintenance clearance is pending; I will check the responsible contact.
- D** Engineering never finishes anything.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

Clean does not yet mean released

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

return to service / room assignment / work order / handover log / readback / status reconciliation / maintenance clearance / release authorization / release hold / housekeeping clearance

- 01 **Leah:** Housekeeping says Room 417 is clean. The guest is waiting, so can I assign it now? The desk needs a clear answer before issuing keys.
- 02 **Marco:** Keep the ¹ _____ in place. Housekeeping has completed its inspection, but the door-lock repair remains open. We need the remaining clearance and the duty manager's release.
- 03 **Leah:** The room screen shows vacant clean. I assumed that meant it was available, since the cleaning team had already finished its part.
- 04 **Marco:** That label describes ² _____ here, not every release condition. We must check the separate maintenance and authorization records rather than infer that all teams have completed their work.
- 05 **Leah:** I see an open work order for the lock. Could it simply be an old entry that someone forgot to close after finishing the repair?
- 06 **Marco:** It could need checking, but the ³ _____ is still open. We cannot turn that possibility into a completed repair. Ask the responsible team for the recorded status.
- 07 **Leah:** The guest is still at the desk. Is 419 released, and does it match the booking? I would rather offer a confirmed alternative now.
- 08 **Marco:** Room 419 has ⁴ _____, housekeeping clearance, and final release. Its room type and the guest-required features have been checked and match. It is the confirmed alternative available now.
- 09 **Leah:** Good. I will assign 419. I will not change 417 to available simply because we have solved this guest's immediate accommodation problem.
- 10 **Marco:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ and the unresolved repair are separate matters. The guest can be accommodated while 417 remains unavailable under the current release process.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Leah:** What should I say if the guest asks why the originally considered room is not ready? I do not want to share a speculative technical diagnosis.
- 12 **Marco:** Say that it is awaiting the required ⁶ _____. Then explain that we have a released room matching the booking. Do not invent a repair deadline or blame a department.
- 13 **Leah:** I will put both statuses in the handover. The next shift needs to see why 417 says clean on one screen but unavailable on the other.
- 14 **Marco:** That calls for ⁷ _____. The labels may describe different checks rather than contradictory facts. Confirm their definitions and ensure reception sees whether final release has actually occurred.
- 15 **Leah:** For the handover, I will record 419 as the assigned room and 417 as unavailable, with its lock work order still open pending verification.
- 16 **Marco:** Include that in the ⁸ _____, together with the contact responsible for checking the maintenance status. Avoid marking the repair complete merely to make two screens display the same word.
- 17 **Leah:** Once the repair is cleared, does reception release 417 directly, or does the duty manager still need to record the final decision?
- 18 **Marco:** The duty manager records ⁹ _____ after both clearances. That is the process in this property. A maintenance update alone does not remove the final authorization requirement.
- 19 **Leah:** Let me repeat the action: assign 419, keep 417 unavailable, check the maintenance record, and wait for the duty manager's release before assigning 417.
- 20 **Marco:** That ¹⁰ _____ is correct. Please confirm the same status with the next shift. We have a practical guest solution and a separate outstanding room issue.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. release hold | 2. housekeeping clearance | 3. work order | 4. maintenance clearance | 5. room assignment | 6. release authorization | 7. status reconciliation | 8. handover log | 9. return to service | 10. readback

A completed task is not a complete release

F Say it

Room 208 has housekeeping clearance but no maintenance clearance or manager release. Room 210 is fully released and matches the booking. The local process requires both clearances and manager release.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unavailable / 210 / release / maintenance

Reception: "The released alternative is Room ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "Room 208 still lacks ² _____ clearance."

Reception: "It also needs the manager's final ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Keep 208 ⁴ _____ until those requirements are met."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. 210 | 2. maintenance | 3. release | 4. unavailable

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-8 with the room numbers clearly separated: four-one-seven and four-one-nine.
2. Repeat turns 15-20, distinguishing maintenance clearance from the final release.
3. Switch roles for the transfer, preserving Room 208 on hold and Room 210 as the released alternative.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

A Read the situation

Turn an assumed event arrangement into a timed, owned, and acknowledged schedule entry.

06

Venue coordinator Ren and event planner Asha compare their schedules. The soundcheck has no confirmed time, room, or owner; each team assumed the other arranged it. They now have a verified slot in Room A from 10:30 to 11:00. Audio lead Vera has accepted responsibility, the required equipment is available, and audience doors open at 11:15. Vera will check the event microphone and playback feed during the slot. Ren will update the controlled run of show and send it to the affected teams; Asha will confirm their acknowledgement. Later changes require coordinated review rather than a silent edit.

PEOPLE / Ren: Venue coordinator | Asha: Event planner

SHARED AWARENESS IS NOT SHARED RESPONSIBILITY

An event team may all know that a soundcheck is needed while nobody has actually arranged it. Name the owner, location, start, finish, and affected handovers. Asking for a readback can be a practical coordination habit rather than a sign of distrust.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was missing from the earlier soundcheck arrangement?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The event's entire audience | B Every piece of equipment in the building |
| C Proof that the event had ended | D Confirmed time, room, and owner |

2. How long is the confirmed soundcheck slot?

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A Fifteen minutes | B Forty-five minutes |
| C One hour | D Thirty minutes |

3. What buffer remains before doors open?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| A Thirty minutes | B No time |
| C Forty-five minutes | D Fifteen minutes |

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

run of show

The timed sequence of event activities and responsibilities.

IN USE update the run of show

soundcheck

A scheduled test of the event's audio setup.

IN USE coordinate the soundcheck

audio lead

The person responsible for the audio work.

IN USE confirm the audio lead

playback feed

The audio signal from recorded material into the system.

IN USE test the playback feed

microphone check

Verification of the required microphone's operation.

IN USE complete a microphone check

doors open

The time attendees may enter the event space.

IN USE confirm doors-open time

cue

A signal to begin a particular event action.

IN USE call the cue

cue sheet

A list of event signals and related actions.

IN USE verify the cue sheet

stage manager

The person coordinating actions around the stage.

IN USE brief the stage manager

technical rehearsal

A practice session checking technical event elements.

IN USE schedule a technical rehearsal

room booking

A confirmed allocation of a space for a time.

IN USE verify the room booking

setup window

Time allocated to preparing the event space.

IN USE protect the setup window

06

Precision check

The soundcheck is 10:30-11:00 in Room A, owned by Vera. Doors open at 11:15, leaving a 15-minute buffer. Moving the soundcheck finish to 11:15 would consume that buffer even if the start remained unchanged.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

strike

Removal of event equipment after use.

IN USE schedule the strike

load-in

Bringing equipment into the event location.

IN USE coordinate the load-in

load-out

Taking equipment out after the event.

IN USE confirm the load-out

banquet event order (BEO)

A detailed document specifying an event's service requirements.

IN USE reconcile the banquet event order

function sheet

A property document listing an event's operational requirements.

IN USE check the function sheet

headcount

The number of people expected or present.

IN USE confirm the headcount

room layout

The arrangement of seating, tables, and equipment.

IN USE approve the room layout

buffer time

Time reserved between activities for transition or delay.

IN USE preserve buffer time

task owner

The person accountable for completing a specified activity.

IN USE name the task owner

schedule version

An identified edition of the event timetable.

IN USE circulate the schedule version

acknowledgement

Confirmation that a message or instruction has been received.

IN USE obtain team acknowledgement

change control

The process for reviewing and communicating alterations.

IN USE follow event change control

Precision check

Sending the updated run of show does not establish that every affected team has received and understood it. Record the version, secure acknowledgement, and coordinate changes that affect the audio lead, room, or doors-open handover.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

EXPOSE THE ASSUMPTION

"We both assumed the other team had arranged it."

CONFIRM THE SLOT

"Room A is available from 10:30 to 11:00."

SPECIFY THE SCOPE

"She will check the event microphone and playback feed."

PROTECT THE NEXT EVENT

"Doors open at 11:15."

NAME THE MISSING DETAILS

"The schedule lacks a time, room, and owner."

NAME THE OWNER

"Vera has accepted responsibility for the soundcheck."

CONFIRM READINESS

"The required equipment is available."

STATE THE BUFFER

"That leaves fifteen minutes between soundcheck and admission."

06

Booked versus assumed

A shared expectation is not a verified arrangement.

From ... to

States the complete time interval, not only its start.

Doors open

Means attendee admission, not the soundcheck start.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

UPDATE THE SHARED RECORD

"I will revise the controlled run of show."

REQUEST ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

"Confirm that the affected teams have received the change."

READ BACK THE DETAILS

"Room A, 10:30 to 11:00, with Vera responsible."

CLARIFY DISTRIBUTION

"Ren will send the schedule; Asha will collect acknowledgements."

IDENTIFY THE CURRENT VERSION

"Please use the updated schedule version."

AVOID A SILENT EDIT

"Any later change needs coordinated review."

DISTINGUISH DURATION

"The soundcheck lasts thirty minutes."

CLOSE THE GAP

"The task now has a confirmed time, place, and owner."

Owner

Name a person with accepted responsibility, not merely a department.

Sent versus acknowledged

Delivery action does not establish receipt or understanding.

Buffer

A planned gap; do not silently allocate it to another activity.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which schedule entry is complete?

- A** Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback feed.
- B** Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, technical team, scope to follow.
- C** Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30, Vera, microphone and playback; finish not listed.
- D** Soundcheck: 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback; room awaiting confirmation.

2. What happens if soundcheck ends at 11:15 with doors unchanged?

- A** The original schedule remains unaffected.
- B** The fifteen-minute buffer disappears.
- C** The buffer grows to thirty minutes.
- D** Doors automatically move to noon.

3. Which statement correctly separates responsibilities?

- A** Nobody owns communication after the edit.
- B** Asha silently edits Vera's task.
- C** Vera alone must guess every team's needs.
- D** Ren updates and sends; Asha confirms affected-team acknowledgement.

4. What is the best response to a later timing change?

- A** Change one private copy only.
- B** Assume the buffer will absorb any delay.
- C** Treat an unread email as acceptance.
- D** Review its effects with the relevant teams and issue an acknowledged update.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

The soundcheck everyone assumed someone else had booked

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Doors open / soundcheck / task owner / change control / assumption / run of show / buffer time / acknowledgement / playback feed / readback

- 01 **Asha:** My team expected the venue to arrange the soundcheck. Your schedule just says audio before doors. Do we have a confirmed room and time anywhere?
- 02 **Ren:** No. That ¹ _____ was shared without a named owner. We need to replace it with a definite entry, not ask both teams to keep expecting the other to act.
- 03 **Asha:** Agreed. I have checked Room A, and the available slot is ten thirty until eleven. Does that fit the equipment and audio lead?
- 04 **Ren:** Yes. Vera has accepted the ² _____ responsibility, and the equipment is available. She will test the event microphone and playback feed during that slot.
- 05 **Asha:** Please replace technical team with Vera on the schedule. I want the presenter to know exactly who is meeting them in Room A.
- 06 **Ren:** Vera will be listed as the ³ _____. I will also include Room A and both times. A start time alone would not show when the space must be ready for the next activity.
- 07 **Asha:** The audience comes in at eleven fifteen. Finishing at eleven gives us fifteen minutes between the audio work and admission, provided nobody silently extends the test.
- 08 **Ren:** Correct. That is our ⁴ _____. It is not an unallocated extra rehearsal slot. Any change that consumes it needs a review of the handover before doors open.
- 09 **Asha:** A presenter asked whether playback was included. They were worried that the microphone might be checked while the recorded material was left until the session itself.
- 10 **Ren:** The ⁵ _____ is part of Vera's confirmed scope. I will put both items in the entry so the presenter and audio team can see the same expectation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Asha:** Which document should people use? There is an old planning email, my event schedule, and a venue copy with the vague audio note.
- 12 **Ren:** I will update the controlled ⁶ _____ and send the identified version to the affected teams. The earlier notes should not remain competing sources for the soundcheck arrangement.
- 13 **Asha:** I will ask the affected teams to confirm receipt. Sending the revised version is necessary, but we need to know they have actually seen the change.
- 14 **Ren:** Thank you. Their ⁷ _____ closes the communication step. If someone raises a conflict, we should resolve it explicitly rather than interpret silence as acceptance of every detail.
- 15 **Asha:** If Vera later needs more time, should she simply edit the finish in the shared document, or contact us before changing the schedule?
- 16 **Ren:** Follow ⁸ _____. A later finish could affect the room handover and audience admission. We need coordinated review and a communicated update before treating a new time as agreed.
- 17 **Asha:** I will flag eleven fifteen to the admission team. They have an older copy with eleven on it, so we need that copy replaced.
- 18 **Ren:** Exactly. ⁹ _____ remains eleven fifteen. Keep that separate from setup and testing times, even though all three activities occur in the same room sequence.
- 19 **Asha:** To confirm: Room A, ten thirty to eleven, Vera responsible, microphone and playback checked, then a fifteen-minute buffer before audience admission.
- 20 **Ren:** That ¹⁰ _____ captures it. I will send the revised run of show, and you will collect team acknowledgements. We now have an arrangement instead of a shared assumption.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. assumption | 2. soundcheck | 3. task owner | 4. buffer time | 5. playback feed | 6. run of show | 7. acknowledgement | 8. change control | 9. Doors open | 10. readback

Protect the handover interval

F Say it

An event test runs from 09:20 to 09:50 in Hall B. Audio lead Jo owns it. Doors open at 10:00. The coordinator must circulate the updated schedule and receive acknowledgement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

acknowledgement / 10 / 30 / Jo

Planner: "The test lasts ¹ _____ minutes."

Coordinator: "The buffer before doors is ² _____ minutes."

Planner: "The named task owner is ³ _____."

Coordinator: "After circulation, collect team ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. 30 | 2. 10 | 3. Jo | 4. acknowledgement

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 3-8, stressing the start, finish, and separate doors-open time.
2. Repeat turns 11-18, distinguishing the current schedule from superseded copies.
3. Switch roles for the transfer, reading the thirty-minute test and ten-minute buffer as separate intervals.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A weather update is not permission to depart

A Read the situation

Communicate an active tour hold, identify decision authority, and give an update without promising departure.

At 09:10, thunderstorms have triggered the tour operator's local departure hold for a coastal excursion. Guests are already inside the hotel's designated indoor waiting lounge, away from windows. Tour-desk agent Camila must keep the group there under the current plan; she cannot clear departure. The operator has not confirmed a route, restart, or cancellation. Operations lead Ben is responsible for the operational decision and will send a status update at 09:30. No refund or alternative excursion has been approved. Camila can promise to relay that update, including an unchanged hold, but cannot promise that the group will leave at 09:30.

PEOPLE / Camila: Tour-desk agent | Mr Ellis: Excursion guest

07

REASSURANCE MUST NOT WEAKEN THE INSTRUCTION

Guests under time pressure may hear an update time as a departure time. State the current hold first, identify the decision-maker, and repeat what guests should do now. A friendly tone should not turn an active safety instruction into an optional suggestion.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the current operational status?

- A** The tour has been canceled.
- B** The coastal route has been cleared.
- C** Departure is on hold under the operator's plan.
- D** Departure is confirmed for 09:30.

2. What should the group do now in this case?

- A** Treat clearer-looking sky as authorization.
- B** Remain in the designated indoor lounge under the current plan.
- C** Wait outside beside the coach.
- D** Decide by a guest vote to depart.

3. Who makes the operational decision?

- A** Any guest who has traveled before
- B** Camila acting independently
- C** The person posting the earliest online comment
- D** Operations lead Ben

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

excursion

A planned short trip or organized visitor activity.

IN USE coordinate a coastal excursion

tour operator

The organization responsible for providing the tour.

IN USE contact the tour operator

departure hold

A temporary restriction preventing the tour from leaving.

IN USE maintain the departure hold

operational clearance

Authorized permission to proceed under the relevant process.

IN USE await operational clearance

operations lead

The person responsible for the operational decision.

IN USE consult the operations lead

weather advisory

Information warning of relevant weather conditions.

IN USE monitor weather advisories

thunderstorm

A storm involving thunder and lightning.

IN USE respond to a thunderstorm

lightning safety plan

A documented procedure for managing lightning-related activity risk.

IN USE follow the lightning safety plan

designated shelter

A specifically identified protective location in the local plan.

IN USE use the designated shelter

indoor waiting area

An internal location assigned for guests awaiting instructions.

IN USE identify the indoor waiting area

route assessment

A review of the conditions affecting a proposed route.

IN USE await the route assessment

itinerary

The planned sequence of trip activities and locations.

IN USE revise the itinerary

Precision check

09:30 is the operator's status-update time. It is not a confirmed departure, restart, route, or cancellation time. Camila relays the authorized status; she does not replace the operations lead's decision with her own forecast.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

departure clearance

Approval for the group or vehicle to leave.

IN USE distinguish departure clearance

restart decision

A determination that a suspended activity may resume.

IN USE communicate the restart decision

cancellation notice

A message confirming that a planned service will not operate.

IN USE issue a cancellation notice

contingency arrangement

A prepared alternative if the original plan cannot proceed.

IN USE verify contingency arrangements

rebooking

Moving a reservation to another service or time.

IN USE check rebooking options

refund eligibility

Whether the applicable conditions permit money to be returned.

IN USE verify refund eligibility

passenger manifest

A controlled list of people on the tour or transport.

IN USE check the passenger manifest

group accountability

Knowing where the members of a group are.

IN USE maintain group accountability

meeting point

The specified place where a group is to assemble.

IN USE confirm the meeting point

communication chain

The route by which authorized information reaches others.

IN USE follow the communication chain

all-clear

An authorized statement that a specified restriction can end.

IN USE avoid an assumed all-clear

travel disruption

An interruption to planned transport or activities.

IN USE explain the travel disruption

Precision check

The active local instruction is to remain in the designated indoor lounge. Do not substitute personal experience, guest pressure, or a brief change in appearance for the operator's safety process. Financial options require separate confirmation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE HOLD FIRST

"Departure is currently on hold."

NAME THE RESPONSIBLE AUTHORITY

"Our operations lead is reviewing the conditions."

GIVE THE COMMUNICATION TIME

"The operator will send an update at 09:30."

KEEP THE INSTRUCTION ACTIVE

"The hold remains in place until authorized instructions change."

EXPLAIN THE PRESENT ACTION

"Please remain in the designated indoor lounge."

AVOID A ROUTE PROMISE

"No route has been confirmed."

SEPARATE THE MEANINGS

"That is an update time, not a departure time."

REJECT AN INFORMAL ALL-CLEAR

"I cannot clear departure based on how the sky looks."

On hold

A temporary operational status, not automatically a cancellation.

At 09:30

Attach the time to update so it is not heard as departure.

Until

States the condition ending an instruction, not an estimated duration.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE INCONVENIENCE

"I understand this affects your plans for the day."

KEEP CANCELLATION DISTINCT

"Cancellation has not been confirmed."

OWN THE COMMUNICATION

"I will relay the operator's update to the group."

CLARIFY A CONDITIONAL OPTION

"Any alternative excursion would need confirmation."

AVOID GUESSING

"I do not have a verified restart time."

KEEP MONEY DECISIONS DISTINCT

"No refund decision has been approved yet."

PRESERVE AN UNCHANGED STATUS

"I will update you even if the hold remains."

CLOSE WITH THE CURRENT INSTRUCTION

"For now, please stay in this designated indoor area."

Not confirmed

Neither approved nor necessarily ruled out.

All-clear

Must come from the authorized process, not casual observation.

Will relay

Commits to communication rather than a favorable operational result.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which announcement is accurate?

- A** We will definitely depart at 09:30.
- B** The weather looks better, so everyone should board now.
- C** Every ticket has already been refunded.
- D** Departure remains on hold; the next operator update is at 09:30.

2. What should Camila do if guests demand an immediate departure?

- A** Repeat the active instruction and refer the decision through the operator's process.
- B** Let a majority vote override the hold.
- C** Invent clearance to reduce frustration.
- D** Send the group outside while waiting for permission.

3. Which statement about cancellation is supported?

- A** It has not been confirmed.
- B** It is certain because a hold exists.
- C** It is impossible because tickets were sold.
- D** It was approved at 09:10.

4. Which financial statement fits the facts?

- A** A status update automatically approves compensation.
- B** Refund eligibility and any remedy still require confirmation.
- C** Every guest is guaranteed an immediate refund.
- D** No guest can ever receive a refund.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A weather update is not permission to depart

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

refund eligibility / indoor waiting area / all-clear / travel disruption / operational clearance / departure hold / status update / communication chain / rebooking / route assessment

07

- 01 **Mr Ellis:** Somebody mentioned nine thirty. Is that our new departure time? Should we get our bags ready outside?
- 02 **Camila:** No. The ¹ _____ remains in place. Please stay in this designated indoor lounge, away from the windows, under the operator's current plan. Nine thirty is the next update.
- 03 **Mr Ellis:** Thank you for making that clear. I am worried about losing the whole day, especially because we booked another activity later this afternoon.
- 04 **Camila:** I understand the ² _____. I will give you verified information as it arrives. At present, no route or restart time has been confirmed, so I cannot promise when the excursion will begin.
- 05 **Mr Ellis:** The sky looks brighter. Could the driver take us out now and avoid the worst part of the coast?
- 06 **Camila:** We need ³ _____, not a judgment based on a brighter patch of sky. Our operations lead, Ben, is responsible for the decision. I cannot clear departure myself.
- 07 **Mr Ellis:** Has the operator canceled it, or are they still deciding? My family heard both versions in the lobby.
- 08 **Camila:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ has not produced a confirmed route for us. Cancellation is also unconfirmed. The current status is a hold, with the group remaining in the designated indoor area.
- 09 **Mr Ellis:** Will we hear from you at nine thirty even without a decision, or should we keep asking at the desk?
- 10 **Camila:** I will relay the ⁵ _____ to the group even if the hold is unchanged. You should not have to interpret silence or assume that no message means permission to leave.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Mr Ellis:** I appreciate that. Would a cancellation mean that we automatically receive our money back, or move to another excursion today?
- 12 **Camila:** I need to verify ⁶ _____ and any available alternatives before promising either outcome. No refund or replacement excursion has been approved. Those arrangements are separate from the immediate departure decision.
- 13 **Mr Ellis:** Please check with us before moving the booking. An afternoon replacement might clash with our other activity, even if it sounds similar.
- 14 **Camila:** Of course. Any ⁷ _____ would need a confirmed option and your agreement. I will explain the actual itinerary and relevant terms if an alternative becomes available, rather than treating it as already arranged.
- 15 **Mr Ellis:** Where should our group wait so that we do not miss the announcement?
- 16 **Camila:** Stay together in this ⁸ _____. If someone needs assistance, please tell the desk. We will use the operator's communication process and keep the current instruction clear until it changes.
- 17 **Mr Ellis:** I will tell the others that nine thirty means news, not departure. I will also explain that neither cancellation nor a refund has been decided.
- 18 **Camila:** That is accurate. There is no ⁹ _____ at present. I know waiting is inconvenient, but I should not soften that message into a suggestion that the group may choose to depart.
- 19 **Mr Ellis:** Understood. We will remain here and wait for the operator's message. Please include us even if the next announcement only says the hold continues.
- 20 **Camila:** I will. The ¹⁰ _____ is Ben to the desk and then to the group. I will make the current status and next instruction explicit when I relay the update.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. departure hold | 2. travel disruption | 3. operational clearance | 4. route assessment | 5. status update | 6. refund eligibility | 7. rebooking | 8. indoor waiting area | 9. all-clear | 10. communication chain

Do not turn a message time into a journey time

F Say it

A local tour hold remains active. The group is in the designated indoor lounge. The operator promises an 11:00 update but has not cleared a route, departure, cancellation, or refund.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

hold / lounge / update / departure

Guest: "Does eleven mean ¹ _____?"

Agent: "No; eleven is the next ² _____."

Guest: "We should remain in the designated indoor ³ _____."

Agent: "Correct; the operational ⁴ _____ remains active."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. departure | 2. update | 3. lounge | 4. hold

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-6, putting the current waiting instruction before the explanation.
2. Repeat turns 9-14, making update, departure, cancellation, and rebooking distinct.
3. Switch roles for the transfer and read the unchanged hold without suggesting permission to board.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

A Read the situation

Clarify an individual service preference, limit its scope, and distinguish a request from a confirmed arrangement.

Ms Rahman declines morning housekeeping on the first day of a three-night stay. A colleague assumes guests from her country never want housekeeping and proposes canceling routine service for the whole stay. Guest-relations agent Nico checks directly. Ms Rahman wants no routine room entry before 14:00 today and would like service after 14:00 if available. The afternoon team has not yet confirmed a slot. Her preference for later days has not been stated. Nico can record today's request and seek confirmation, but cannot promise the time or infer future preferences. Emergency access follows the property's separate rules.

PEOPLE / Nico: Guest-relations agent | Ms Rahman: Staying guest

08

ASK WITHOUT MAKING THE GUEST DEFEND A GROUP

People differ within every nationality and language community. A neutral question about today's service is more useful than an explanation of what people from a country supposedly prefer. Confirm the individual choice, its time period, and whether the requested service is actually available.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Ms Rahman want before 14:00 today?

- A No routine room entry
- B No service for the entire stay
- C An immediate room inspection
- D Automatic cancellation of the booking

2. What is the status of afternoon service?

- A Guaranteed at 14:00
- B Completed
- C Refused for every day
- D Requested but not yet confirmed

3. What is known about later days?

- A The same time is guaranteed.
- B Nationality supplies the missing preference.
- C No preference has been stated.
- D Service is permanently declined.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

service preference

An individual's stated choice about how service is provided.

IN USE clarify a service preference

routine room entry

Entry for ordinary scheduled room service tasks.

IN USE limit routine room entry

do-not-disturb request

A request to avoid routine interruption.

IN USE record a do-not-disturb request

stayover service

Housekeeping provided while a guest continues a stay.

IN USE coordinate stayover service

service window

A period during which a service may be provided.

IN USE confirm the service window

afternoon slot

An available time allocation later in the day.

IN USE verify an afternoon slot

service frequency

How often a service is provided.

IN USE clarify service frequency

opt out

Choose not to receive a specified optional service.

IN USE opt out for today

opt in

Choose to receive a specified optional service.

IN USE opt in to service

preference note

A record of an explicitly stated service choice.

IN USE update the preference note

scope of request

The limits of what a person has asked for.

IN USE confirm the scope of request

duration of stay

The total period of the guest's visit.

IN USE distinguish the duration of stay

Precision check

No routine entry before 14:00 today is narrower than no housekeeping for three nights. A request for service after 14:00 does not establish a start at exactly 14:00, nor guarantee that an afternoon slot exists.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

assumed preference

A choice attributed to someone without confirmation.

IN USE question an assumed preference

stereotype

A generalized belief applied to an individual because of group membership.

IN USE avoid a cultural stereotype

individual variation

Differences among people within the same group.

IN USE recognize individual variation

clarifying question

A question resolving a specific ambiguity.

IN USE ask a clarifying question

neutral wording

Language that avoids unsupported judgments or assumptions.

IN USE use neutral wording

form of address

The name or title used when speaking to someone.

IN USE ask the preferred form of address

language preference

The language a person chooses for communication.

IN USE check language preference

communication style

A person's preferred manner of interaction.

IN USE adapt communication style

personal space

The distance or privacy a person prefers in an interaction.

IN USE respect personal space

interruption

An action that breaks someone's current activity or privacy.

IN USE avoid an unnecessary interruption

service confirmation

Verification that the requested service has been arranged.

IN USE await service confirmation

emergency access

Entry governed by separate urgent-situation procedures.

IN USE distinguish emergency access

08

Precision check

Record what the guest actually says, with the relevant day and service scope. Do not add nationality-based explanations or silently extend the preference to future days. Routine privacy requests do not redefine the property's separate emergency-access rules.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT THE SERVICE

"Would you prefer service later today or no service today?"

CLARIFY THE REQUESTED OPTION

"You would like housekeeping after 14:00 if available."

AVOID AN EXACT-TIME PROMISE

"After 14:00 does not mean a confirmed start at 14:00."

AVOID A GROUP ASSUMPTION

"I will check your preference directly."

CONFIRM THE TIME BOUNDARY

"You would like no routine entry before 14:00 today."

KEEP AVAILABILITY HONEST

"I still need to check an afternoon slot."

LIMIT THE PERIOD

"I will record that for today only."

USE THE GUEST'S WORDS

"The note should describe the service and timing you requested."

08

Today

Prevents a one-day preference from becoming a whole-stay rule.

After versus at

After sets a lower time boundary; at names a particular time.

If available

Keeps the requested option conditional until checked.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK A FUTURE PREFERENCE

"We have not yet discussed the later days."

OFFER A CLEAR NEXT STEP

"I will contact the afternoon team and confirm the available option."

CORRECT THE EARLIER INFERENCE

"Declining this morning did not mean declining the whole stay."

BOUND THE POLICY

"Emergency access follows the property's separate rules."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND CONFIRMATION

"The request is recorded; the service time is not confirmed."

RESPECT THE INTERACTION

"I do not need a personal explanation for that preference."

KEEP THE RECORD NEUTRAL

"No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested."

CLOSE WITH A READBACK

"Let me repeat the request so I record it accurately."

08

Decline

Specify exactly which service or timing was declined.

Would you prefer

Gives a neutral choice without demanding a cultural explanation.

Recorded versus arranged

A saved preference is not proof that staffing is confirmed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which note is accurate?

- A** No housekeeping for this nationality.
- B** Cancel all service for three nights.
- C** Service guaranteed at exactly 14:00.
- D** No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested, slot pending.

2. Which question avoids stereotyping?

- A** Why are all your compatriots so private?
- B** Would you prefer service later today or no service today?
- C** Do people from your country dislike housekeeping?
- D** Your nationality means you never need service, correct?

3. What needs confirmation before promising afternoon service?

- A** An available slot from the afternoon team
- B** The guest's nationality
- C** The employee's general impression
- D** A guess based on the empty corridor

4. Which statement about future days is supported?

- A** An individual preference cannot ever change.
- B** Their service preference remains unstated.
- C** Today automatically controls every later day.
- D** Three nights means exactly three afternoon services are booked.

Answers and explanations: [page 99](#).

A timing preference is not a nationality-based rule

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

whole stay / time window / housekeeping note / privacy / factual / confirmation / assumption / routine service / afternoon slot / preference

08

- 01 **Nico:** Ms Rahman, may I check your housekeeping request? Would you like service later today, or would you prefer to skip it today?
- 02 **Ms Rahman:** Later, please. I would like some ¹ _____ this morning. Please do not send anyone in before two, but I would still like the room serviced afterward if possible.
- 03 **Nico:** Certainly. I will ask the afternoon team what they can arrange, then come back to you with an available time.
- 04 **Ms Rahman:** Thank you. An ² _____ would work. It does not have to be exactly two. I just do not want another knock before then.
- 05 **Nico:** I also need to correct our earlier note. It says you declined housekeeping for all three nights. Is that what you intended?
- 06 **Ms Rahman:** No, not for the ³ _____. I only declined this morning. Please do not cancel the other days because of that.
- 07 **Nico:** I am sorry; that note went beyond what you asked. I will correct it to today's request only.
- 08 **Ms Rahman:** Someone also said guests from my country usually want no service. That felt like an ⁴ _____ about me. Please just ask what I need.
- 09 **Nico:** You are right. We should have asked you directly. I will keep the note about the service and timing, not your nationality.
- 10 **Ms Rahman:** Good. My ⁵ _____ today is a quiet morning and housekeeping later if you have space. That is all I need the team to know.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Nico:** I have entered no routine entry before two today; later housekeeping requested, awaiting the team's reply. Does that describe it correctly?
- 12 **Ms Rahman:** Yes. Could you make sure the ⁶ _____ still says I want service later? I do not want the afternoon team to think I refused everything.
- 13 **Nico:** It does. This covers ordinary housekeeping visits; the hotel's separate emergency procedures are unchanged.
- 14 **Ms Rahman:** Understood. I am asking about ⁷ _____, not emergencies. Please let me know if the afternoon team cannot fit me in.
- 15 **Nico:** I will. I have recorded the request, but I still need their answer before I can say it is arranged.
- 16 **Ms Rahman:** Please send me the ⁸ _____ once you have it. A recorded request has been mistaken for a booking on another stay.
- 17 **Nico:** Certainly. We can check tomorrow's arrangements separately when you know what you would like.
- 18 **Ms Rahman:** That suits me. I may want a different ⁹ _____ tomorrow, but I have not decided. Please leave tomorrow's timing open for now.
- 19 **Nico:** To confirm today's request: no routine visit before two, housekeeping afterward if available, and no change requested for the remaining days.
- 20 **Ms Rahman:** Correct. That is a clear, ¹⁰ _____ note. Thank you for correcting it. I will wait for your message about the afternoon.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. privacy | 2. afternoon slot | 3. whole stay | 4. assumption | 5. preference | 6. housekeeping note | 7. routine service | 8. confirmation | 9. time window | 10. factual

A one-day request stays a one-day request

F Say it

A guest asks for no routine service before 15:00 today and requests later service if available. The team has not confirmed a slot. No preference has been stated for tomorrow.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unstated / stereotype / availability / 15:00

Agent: "The no-entry boundary is before ¹ _____ today."

Guest: "Later service is subject to ² _____."

Agent: "Tomorrow's preference remains ³ _____."

Guest: "Please record my individual request without a cultural
⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. 15:00 | 2. availability | 3. unstated | 4. stereotype

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read the completed script, giving the guest time to correct the whole-stay assumption.
2. Repeat turns 11-16, distinguishing the recorded request from the service confirmation.
3. Switch roles for the transfer and stress today without applying that timing to tomorrow.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The banking app still shows the hotel hold

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Explain pending and completed card transactions without promising a bank-controlled release time.

After checkout, a guest sees a \$350 pending hotel authorization and a \$280 posted payment. The final bill is room \$240, supplied tax \$24, and parking \$16. Hotel records show one completed \$280 payment and a request to release the unused authorization. The issuer has not confirmed its display or release timing.

PEOPLE / Ms Bennett: Guest | Idris: Front-desk supervisor

09

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

release request / authorization hold / available balance / card issuer / itemized folio / settled payment

- 01 **Ms Bennett:** My receipt says two hundred eighty dollars, but my banking app also shows three hundred fifty. Have you charged me twice?
- 02 **Idris:** Let us check the entries separately. The three hundred fifty appears as an ¹ _____, while the two hundred eighty is posted. I will compare that with our payment record.
- 03 **Ms Bennett:** The larger amount was there when I checked in. I assumed it was the room payment, so I was surprised to see another entry today.
- 04 **Idris:** Our record shows the check-in authorization and one completed payment at checkout. I understand why the two entries together are concerning.
- 05 **Ms Bennett:** Can you show what makes up the two hundred eighty? I did not buy anything from the minibar.
- 06 **Idris:** Here is the ² _____: room two hundred forty, tax twenty-four, and parking sixteen. There is no minibar charge on this bill.
- 07 **Ms Bennett:** Those add to two hundred eighty. The parking is correct. What happened to the remaining seventy from the larger amount?
- 08 **Idris:** That difference is not an extra charge on your folio. We have asked for the unused authorization to be released; that is not a seventy-dollar refund of a completed payment.
- 09 **Ms Bennett:** So your records show two hundred eighty paid, rather than six hundred thirty paid in total?
- 10 **Idris:** Correct. There is one ³ _____ in our record. The pending entry can still affect what you have available while it is being resolved.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Ms Bennett:** I need to use the card for another hotel tonight. Can you remove the pending entry before I get there?
- 12 **Idris:** I can check the ⁴ _____ and provide its recorded details. I cannot control when your card provider updates the account or guarantee that it will happen today.
- 13 **Ms Bennett:** I would appreciate something I can give them. Please do not just tell me to wait without checking whether the request went through.
- 14 **Idris:** I will verify the request with our payments team and send you the final folio through our approved private channel. We can also supply the relevant transaction reference securely.
- 15 **Ms Bennett:** Should I send you a screenshot of the entire banking screen? It includes the card number and several other purchases.
- 16 **Idris:** Do not send the full screen or card number by ordinary email. Use our secure process for any details needed, and contact your ⁵ _____ through its verified contact channel.
- 17 **Ms Bennett:** The available amount is lower, even though you say the second entry is pending. That is the part causing the problem for me.
- 18 **Idris:** I understand. A hold can reduce your available funds or credit without being a second completed charge. We should not dismiss that practical effect.
- 19 **Ms Bennett:** Please send the verified documents and tell me what the payments team confirms. I will ask my issuer about the pending entry and what I can use tonight.
- 20 **Idris:** I will follow up with the verified status. Ask the issuer about your ⁶ _____, not just the posted total. If another completed charge appears, let us investigate it rather than assume it is still the same hold.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. authorization hold | 2. itemized folio | 3. settled payment | 4. release request | 5. card issuer | 6. available balance

Do not add pending to posted as a final bill

F Say it in a new situation

A guest sees a \$220 pending authorization and a \$180 posted hotel payment. The itemized final folio totals \$180. The hotel has requested release of the unused authorization, but the issuer has not confirmed when it will disappear.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / timing / refund / 180

Guest: "The final itemized bill is ¹ _____ dollars."

Agent: "The separate authorization is still labeled ² _____."

Guest: "The forty-dollar difference is not automatically a cash ³ _____."

Agent: "The issuer must confirm the release ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. 180 | 2. pending | 3. refund | 4. timing

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Accessible describes features, not one standard room

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Check a guest's required features and complete a reservation without substituting assumptions.

Ms Diaz needs two separate beds and a roll-in shower with a fixed seat. For her dates, the hotel has verified Room A with one king bed and a roll-in shower, Room B with two beds and a tub, and Room C with two queen beds and the requested shower and seat. Room C is available.

PEOPLE / Ms Diaz: Guest | Owen: Reservations agent

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

access needs / specific features / layout / roll-in shower / bed configuration / reservation

- 01 **Ms Diaz:** Your website lists several accessible rooms, but I cannot tell which has two beds and a roll-in shower with a fixed seat.
- 02 **Owen:** Let me check those ¹ _____ for your dates. I will describe what is verified rather than assume every accessible room is the same.
- 03 **Ms Diaz:** Thank you. I am traveling with a companion, so one king bed will not work. We need separate beds.
- 04 **Owen:** Room A has a roll-in shower but one king bed. That does not meet the bed requirement. Room B has two beds, but its bathroom has a tub.
- 05 **Ms Diaz:** A tub with grab bars would not replace the shower I asked for. Is there a room with both features together?
- 06 **Owen:** Yes. Room C has two queen beds and a ² _____ with a fixed seat. Its current feature record confirms both, and it is available for your dates.
- 07 **Ms Diaz:** That sounds right. I also need to know whether there is a step-free route from the entrance to that room.
- 08 **Owen:** I will verify the route details with our on-site team before you decide. I have the room features, but I do not want to invent information about the route.
- 09 **Ms Diaz:** Could you also send the bathroom layout? A description of accessible does not tell me where the seat is in relation to the controls.
- 10 **Owen:** I can request the current ³ _____ and any verified measurements you need. You can tell me which details matter; you do not need to explain a medical diagnosis.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Ms Diaz:** Please check the seat and control positions. I will assess whether the layout works for me from that information.
- 12 **Owen:** Certainly. Your ⁴ _____ guide what we verify. I will keep the actual features in the reservation notes, not substitute a general label.
- 13 **Ms Diaz:** If I reserve it, could another guest be given that room and leave me with the tub room at check-in?
- 14 **Owen:** We must preserve the confirmed required features in the booking. I will follow the room-blocking process, not treat either of the other room types as an equivalent replacement.
- 15 **Ms Diaz:** Please send the route and layout details first. Once I have checked them, I would like to complete the booking for Room C.
- 16 **Owen:** That is fine. This conversation has confirmed availability, but it has not yet completed your ⁵ _____. I will make that status clear in my message.
- 17 **Ms Diaz:** And please show the room rate and cancellation terms in that message too. I need the same booking information as for any other room.
- 18 **Owen:** Of course. I will include the verified features, the requested route and layout information once checked, and the applicable rate and terms together.
- 19 **Ms Diaz:** Good. Do not switch me to a one-bed room to preserve the shower, or a tub room to preserve the beds. I need both.
- 20 **Owen:** Understood. The ⁶ _____ and shower requirements are linked in this request. I will follow up with the missing information so you can make an informed choice.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. specific features | 2. roll-in shower | 3. layout | 4. access needs | 5. reservation | 6. bed configuration

Check the combination, not the label

F Say it in a new situation

A guest requires two separate beds and a roll-in shower. Room 1 has one king bed and that shower. Room 2 has two beds and a tub. Available Room 3 has two beds and a roll-in shower. Route information still needs checking before the guest decides.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

combination / route / 3 / reservation

Agent: "The verified feature match is Room ¹ _____."

Guest: "Two beds with a tub are not an equivalent ² _____."

Agent: "The remaining information concerns the ³ _____."

Guest: "Availability alone does not complete my ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. 3 | 2. combination | 3. route | 4. reservation

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

Room and tax to the organizer, extras to the guest

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Translate group billing instructions into accurate charge routing and a reconciled readback.

A fictional group agreement makes the organizer responsible for room and supplied room tax only. Each guest pays parking and breakfast. One two-night folio shows room \$150 per night, tax \$15 per night, parking \$20 total, and breakfast \$30 total. The current routing incorrectly sends everything to the organizer. No payment has been settled.

PEOPLE / Inez: Group coordinator | Cal: Hotel cashier

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

11

WORD + PHRASE BANK

individual folio / audit trail / master account / charge transfer / routing instructions / billing dispute

- 01 **Inez:** The organizer's draft bill includes parking and breakfast. Our agreement says room and tax only. Could we check the routing before checkout?
- 02 **Cal:** Yes. The ¹ _____ is receiving all charge codes at present. That is wider than the signed billing instructions.
- 03 **Inez:** For this reservation, the room is one hundred fifty per night for two nights, with fifteen tax each night.
- 04 **Cal:** That makes three hundred in room charges and thirty in room tax. The organizer's share should be three hundred thirty for this guest.
- 05 **Inez:** Parking is twenty total and breakfast is thirty total. Those are guest-paid, not thirty dollars of breakfast on each night.
- 06 **Cal:** Understood. The ² _____ should carry fifty dollars. I will keep the two-night room amounts separate from the supplied total extras.
- 07 **Inez:** The total bill is still three hundred eighty. We are changing who pays, not removing the parking or breakfast charge.
- 08 **Cal:** Exactly. The revised split must reconcile to the same total. A transfer between folios is not a discount or a refund.
- 09 **Inez:** Will changing the instructions affect only tonight's new charges, or also the items already posted on this draft?
- 10 **Cal:** I will check both. The ³ _____ need correction, and the existing postings must be reviewed under our system's adjustment process.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **Inez:** Please retain a record of the transfer. The organizer will ask why the revised statement differs from the draft they saw this morning.
- 12 **Cal:** I will preserve the ⁴ _____ and use the approved correction method. We should not delete the extras and re-enter an unexplained lump sum.
- 13 **Inez:** One guest says their manager told them breakfast would be covered. I do not have written approval changing the group agreement.
- 14 **Cal:** We will refer that discrepancy to the authorized group contact. I cannot expand the master-account scope based on an unverified verbal message.
- 15 **Inez:** For now, can reception explain the written arrangement at checkout without making the guest feel accused of charging the wrong account?
- 16 **Cal:** Yes. We can say room and tax are covered by the organizer, with these listed extras payable individually. If the guest raises a ⁵ _____, we will record it and seek the required decision.
- 17 **Inez:** No money has been taken yet. Please do not call the fifty-dollar correction a refund in the email to the organizer.
- 18 **Cal:** Agreed. It is a correction to the unpaid folio allocation. We will issue the appropriate final statements once the split and any dispute are resolved.
- 19 **Inez:** Read back this one for me: three hundred thirty to the organizer, fifty to the guest, three hundred eighty altogether.
- 20 **Cal:** That reconciles. I will complete the ⁶ _____ and verify the revised statements before settlement. The corrected instructions must also reach the next cashier.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. master account | 2. individual folio | 3. routing instructions | 4. audit trail | 5. billing dispute | 6. charge transfer

A payer change does not change the total

F Say it in a new situation

An unpaid two-night bill has room \$120 per night, room tax \$12 per night, and guest-paid parking \$18 total. The organizer covers room and tax only. No other charges apply.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

refund / 282 / 264 / 18

Coordinator: "The organizer pays ¹ _____ dollars."

Cashier: "The guest pays ² _____ dollars."

Coordinator: "The combined bill remains ³ _____ dollars."

Cashier: "Changing the unpaid allocation is not a ⁴ _____."

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. 264 | 2. 18 | 3. 282 | 4. refund

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What did the confirmation establish?

A. The early-arrival request was recorded.

The wording recorded the request but did not confirm early access.

2. What can Arun provide now?

B. Complimentary luggage storage and lobby seating

The brief confirms these two immediate services, not a room or financial remedy.

3. What does the 13:00 commitment concern?

B. A personal status update

Arun controls the update; no room-ready time has been verified.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which reply handles the misunderstanding best?

A. I see why you expected noon access; the request was recorded, but no room is released yet.

The correct reply acknowledges the expectation and preserves the verified room status.

2. Which promise is within Arun's stated control?

D. I will update you at 13:00 even if we are still waiting.

The brief authorizes a status update, not a room guarantee or financial remedy.

3. Which statement accurately explains complimentary storage?

D. We can hold your luggage without an additional charge.

Complimentary describes the storage charge only, not the wider booking terms.

4. What should Arun do if compensation is requested?

D. Refer the request for the duty manager's review.

Arun lacks personal authority to approve compensation but can seek the appropriate review.

01 Conversation answers

Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. frustration.** Turn 2. Frustration acknowledges the effect of the unclear message without claiming that noon access was actually guaranteed.
- 2. early-arrival request.** Turn 4. The request was recorded with the booking, but recording it did not establish guaranteed early access.
- 3. room-ready time.** Turn 6. The room-ready time remains unknown; the agent must not replace that uncertainty with a guessed promise.
- 4. complimentary.** Turn 8. Complimentary means the luggage storage is available without an additional charge, not that the entire stay is free.
- 5. status update.** Turn 10. A status update communicates the current position; it is the action Arun can reliably commit to at thirteen hundred.
- 6. front desk.** Turn 12. The front desk is the reception point where Arun remains responsible for communicating the next update.
- 7. duty manager.** Turn 14. The duty manager is the appropriate person to review the communication concern and any remedy beyond Arun's authority.
- 8. review.** Turn 16. Review means the request will be considered; it does not mean compensation has already been authorized.
- 9. claim ticket.** Turn 18. The claim ticket identifies the stored bags and supports their later retrieval.
- 10. follow-through.** Turn 20. Follow-through means carrying out the promised check and update, not merely making a reassuring statement.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. room access

Guest: "Is noon a guaranteed time for room access?"

The question concerns entry, which remains unconfirmed despite the scheduled update.

2. update

Agent: "No; noon is the time for my update."

The agent controls the noon communication, not the unverified room release.

3. luggage

Guest: "Can you hold my luggage while I wait?"

Storage of the guest's bags is the immediate confirmed service.

4. complimentary

Agent: "Yes, that service is complimentary."

The brief explicitly states that luggage storage is free.

02 Briefing and language checks

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is established about the noise complaint?

C. It has been reported but not yet checked.

The brief supplies an unverified complaint, not a completed investigation or remedy.

2. Which information should be removed from the public draft?

D. Room number, stay dates, and booking reference

These booking details belong in the appropriate private process, not the public reply.

3. What may an approved remedy depend on here?

D. The outcome of the service review and applicable policy

The fictional policy makes remedies independent of whether the guest changes the review.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which public reply is most appropriate?

B. We are sorry to hear about the noise concern; please contact our published guest-relations channel so we can review it.

The correct reply acknowledges the concern and offers a private next step without inventing findings.

2. Which internal note is suitably neutral?

D. The guest reports late-night noise; verification is pending.

It distinguishes the reported experience from the pending factual review.

3. Which proposal should be rejected?

D. Offer a credit only if the guest removes the review.

Linking a benefit to review removal improperly conditions service recovery on the review.

4. What does posting the public reply establish?

D. The concern has received an acknowledgement and a next step.

A public acknowledgement does not itself establish investigation, remedy, or acceptance.

02 Conversation answers

Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. public reply.** Turn 2. A public reply is visible beyond the original reviewer, so its wording must suit the wider audience.
- 2. booking reference.** Turn 4. The booking reference and other reservation details should not be exposed in the public response.
- 3. guest feedback.** Turn 6. Guest feedback identifies the reported experience without pretending that its factual review is already complete.
- 4. acknowledgement.** Turn 8. An acknowledgement recognizes the concern and does not by itself confirm every allegation or approve a remedy.
- 5. defensive tone.** Turn 10. A defensive tone shifts attention from helping with the complaint to protecting the property from criticism.
- 6. incident log.** Turn 12. The incident log may contain relevant reports and actions; it is a source to check, not a presumed verdict.
- 7. conditional offer.** Turn 14. The proposed credit is improperly conditional on removing the review rather than on the service-review outcome.
- 8. service remedy.** Turn 16. A service remedy is an authorized response to the service problem, not an outcome already decided by acknowledging the complaint.
- 9. case record.** Turn 18. The case record should track responsibility, relevant facts, and actions so the private review does not lose continuity.
- 10. resolution status.** Turn 20. Resolution status records where the complaint actually stands; posting a reply is not the same as resolving it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. reservation code

Manager: "Remove the reservation code from the public response."

The reservation identifier is private booking information, not necessary public reply content.

2. acknowledgement

Agent: "We can give a courteous acknowledgement now."

Recognition of the concern is appropriate before the factual review is complete.

3. factual check

Manager: "The complaint still needs a factual check."

The brief states that no investigation has yet been completed.

4. deletion

Agent: "Any approved voucher must be independent of review deletion."

A service remedy must not be conditional on removing the review.

03 Briefing and language checks

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which alternative preserves the booked bed arrangement?

B. The king room at Harbor Hotel

Harbor Hotel has the verified king-bed alternative; the on-site room has two separate beds.

2. What costs are approved for the off-site option?

D. The room-price difference and transfer

The brief limits the approved package to the room-price difference and transfer.

3. Has the guest accepted an alternative?

C. No; his choice is still required.

Both alternatives are available, but the guest has not selected one.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which description is most accurate?

D. The twin room is on-site but has two separate beds.

The correct description preserves the verified difference in bed configuration.

2. Which statement overpromises?

B. We will pay every expense you incur.

The approval does not extend to every incidental or future expense.

3. What should happen before changing the booking?

A. Explain the alternatives and obtain the guest's choice.

The guest has not selected an alternative and needs accurate information before agreeing.

4. Which handover is complete in principle?

B. Verify the chosen booking, receiving contact, arrival details, and approved transfer.

A practical relocation requires coordination of the selected accommodation and its agreed supporting arrangements.

03 Conversation answers

Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. room type. Turn 2. Room type identifies the accommodation category that cannot be supplied tonight, rather than suggesting the entire reservation never existed.

2. twin room. Turn 4. A twin room has two separate beds and therefore does not preserve the guest's booked king-bed arrangement.

3. receiving property. Turn 6. The receiving property is Harbor Hotel, which has verified the relevant accommodation for tonight.

4. rate difference. Turn 8. The rate difference is the additional room-price amount the original property has specifically approved paying.

5. consent. Turn 10. Consent means the guest agrees to the specific alternative after hearing the differences and approved costs.

6. booking amendment. Turn 12. The booking amendment records the guest's selected change; it is distinct from merely identifying an available alternative.

7. relocation. Turn 14. Relocation means accommodation at another property; the approved transfer means the guest is not simply told to walk there.

8. transfer. Turn 16. The transfer is the transport arrangement, which requires its own confirmation even though the room option is available.

9. arrival instructions. Turn 18. Arrival instructions make the receiving handover practical by explaining where to go and what booking information is needed.

10. readback. Turn 20. A readback repeats the agreed details so both parties can correct any misunderstanding before the relocation is carried out.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. bed configuration

Agent: "The local option has a different bed configuration."

Two singles differ from the king bed originally booked.

2. king bed

Guest: "The nearby option preserves the king bed."

The verified nearby room contains the requested king bed.

3. transport

Agent: "Our offer includes the price difference and transport."

These are the two costs explicitly approved in the scenario.

4. booking

Guest: "Please confirm the details before changing my booking."

A change should follow informed agreement and completed coordination.

04 Briefing and language checks

Revenue Management and Pricing

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What is Night B's average daily rate?

A. \$120

Room revenue of \$7,200 divided by sixty sold rooms equals \$120.

2. What is Night B's revenue per available room?

B. \$72

The denominator is all one hundred available rooms, giving seventy-two dollars.

3. What cannot be calculated from the supplied figures?

A. Profit

Costs are not supplied, so room revenue measures do not establish profit.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which summary is accurate?

B. ADR rose while occupancy, RevPAR, and room revenue fell.

The supplied calculations show higher sold-room rate but lower volume and capacity-based revenue.

2. Which calculation gives Night A's RevPAR?

A. \$8,000 divided by 100

RevPAR divides room revenue by available room supply, not sold rooms.

3. Which occupancy change is correctly stated?

C. A fall of 20 percentage points

Eighty percent minus sixty percent is twenty points; the relative fall is twenty-five percent.

4. Which causal claim is justified by these two nights alone?

B. None; further evidence is needed to isolate a pricing effect.

The comparison reports outcomes but does not control other influences on demand.

04 Conversation answers

Revenue Management and Pricing

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

- 1. ADR.** Turn 2. ADR measures average room revenue among sold rooms, so it can rise while overall room revenue falls.
- 2. rooms available.** Turn 4. Rooms available is the common supply denominator, which stayed at one hundred on both nights.
- 3. occupancy.** Turn 6. Occupancy is rooms sold divided by available rooms, giving eighty percent on Night A and sixty percent on Night B.
- 4. RevPAR.** Turn 8. RevPAR uses all available rooms as the denominator, producing eighty dollars on Night A and seventy-two on Night B.
- 5. room revenue.** Turn 10. Room revenue fell from eight thousand to seven thousand two hundred dollars, the same ten-percent decline with unchanged supply.
- 6. cost figures.** Turn 12. Cost figures are needed before a revenue comparison can support a conclusion about profit.
- 7. non-room revenue.** Turn 14. Non-room revenue is outside the supplied room-only figures, so no total-property revenue conclusion is established.
- 8. price elasticity.** Turn 16. Price elasticity concerns how demand responds to price; two uncontrolled nights do not establish that response.
- 9. channel mix.** Turn 18. Channel mix identifies how sales are distributed across booking routes and can add context to revenue and distribution-cost analysis.
- 10. trade-off.** Turn 20. The trade-off is the higher average rate alongside fewer sold rooms, without asserting a proven cause or profit outcome.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 80

Analyst: "Occupancy is 80 percent."

Forty sold rooms divided by fifty available rooms equals eighty percent.

2. 150

Manager: "ADR is 150 dollars."

Six thousand dollars divided by forty sold rooms equals one hundred fifty.

3. 120

Analyst: "RevPAR is 120 dollars."

Six thousand dollars divided by fifty available rooms equals one hundred twenty.

4. profit

Manager: "We cannot calculate profit from these figures alone."

The case supplies revenue but no relevant cost figures.

05 Briefing and language checks

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What is missing for Room 417?

A. Maintenance clearance and final release

Housekeeping is complete, but the repair remains open and release is unrecorded.

2. Which room can reception assign on the supplied facts?

A. Room 419

Room 419 is released and its required features match the guest's needs.

3. Who performs the final release in this fictional process?

B. The duty manager

The brief explicitly assigns final release to the duty manager after both clearances.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Assign 419; keep 417 on hold until its required clearances and release are recorded.

The released and suitable alternative meets the guest need without bypassing 417's outstanding requirements.

2. What does the housekeeping inspection prove here?

D. The housekeeping checks are complete.

A department-specific inspection does not establish another department's clearance or final authorization.

3. Which statement about room-status codes is safest?

D. Check the property's definitions and release rules.

Local status definitions and the stated release process determine their operational meaning.

4. Which response avoids blaming a team?

C. Maintenance clearance is pending; I will check the responsible contact.

It states the actionable status and next step without an unsupported general accusation.

05 Conversation answers

Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. release hold. Turn 2. The release hold prevents assignment while the required maintenance clearance and final authorization remain outstanding.

2. housekeeping clearance. Turn 4. Housekeeping clearance covers housekeeping's checks and cannot stand in for maintenance clearance or the final room release.

3. work order. Turn 6. The work order is the maintenance record requiring verification; its possible staleness is not proof the repair is complete.

4. maintenance clearance. Turn 8. Maintenance clearance is already recorded for 419, alongside its housekeeping clearance and final release.

5. room assignment. Turn 10. The room assignment concerns 419 only; providing that alternative does not change the unresolved status of 417.

6. release authorization. Turn 12. Release authorization is the missing operational permission, which can be described without guessing at the technical fault or repair time.

7. status reconciliation. Turn 14. Status reconciliation checks what each label means and resolves the records without automatically treating different department statuses as contradictions.

8. handover log. Turn 16. The handover log transfers the actual room assignment, unresolved item, and responsibility to the next shift.

9. return to service. Turn 18. Return to service requires the stated final release after both department clearances; reception does not bypass that step.

10. readback. Turn 20. The readback confirms the room numbers, hold, and release sequence so the two departments act on the same information.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 210

Reception: "The released alternative is Room 210."

The brief identifies 210 as released and suitable for the booking.

2. maintenance

Coordinator: "Room 208 still lacks maintenance clearance."

Only housekeeping clearance has been recorded for Room 208.

3. release

Reception: "It also needs the manager's final release."

The local process requires a separate final manager authorization.

4. unavailable

Coordinator: "Keep 208 unavailable until those requirements are met."

Assignment must wait for the outstanding clearance and release.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What was missing from the earlier soundcheck arrangement?

D. Confirmed time, room, and owner

Both teams assumed the other had arranged the task, leaving these details unconfirmed.

2. How long is the confirmed soundcheck slot?

D. Thirty minutes

The slot runs from 10:30 until 11:00, a thirty-minute duration.

3. What buffer remains before doors open?

D. Fifteen minutes

Soundcheck finishes at 11:00 and doors open at 11:15.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which schedule entry is complete?

A. Soundcheck: Room A, 10:30-11:00, Vera, microphone and playback feed.

Only the complete entry preserves all confirmed details: location, interval, named owner, and test scope.

2. What happens if soundcheck ends at 11:15 with doors unchanged?

B. The fifteen-minute buffer disappears.

The revised finish coincides with admission, leaving no transition buffer.

3. Which statement correctly separates responsibilities?

D. Ren updates and sends; Asha confirms affected-team acknowledgement.

The brief assigns preparation and distribution to Ren and acknowledgement follow-up to Asha.

4. What is the best response to a later timing change?

D. Review its effects with the relevant teams and issue an acknowledged update.

Changes can affect dependencies and must reach the teams expected to act on them.

06 Conversation answers

Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. assumption. Turn 2. The assumption is the unverified belief that another team had arranged the soundcheck; it left essential details unconfirmed.

2. soundcheck. Turn 4. The soundcheck is the scheduled audio test Vera will conduct in the verified room and time slot.

3. task owner. Turn 6. The task owner is the named person who has accepted responsibility, avoiding an ambiguous department-level assignment.

4. buffer time. Turn 8. Buffer time is the fifteen-minute interval between the eleven o'clock soundcheck finish and eleven-fifteen audience admission.

5. playback feed. Turn 10. The playback feed is explicitly included alongside the event microphone in Vera's soundcheck scope.

6. run of show. Turn 12. The run of show is the shared timed event record that should carry the current soundcheck details.

7. acknowledgement. Turn 14. Acknowledgement confirms that the update reached the relevant teams; sending it alone does not establish that shared awareness.

8. change control. Turn 16. Change control requires reviewing and communicating the effect of a later adjustment rather than silently changing a dependent schedule.

9. Doors open. Turn 18. Doors open identifies the audience-admission time, which is eleven fifteen rather than the eleven o'clock technical finish.

10. readback. Turn 20. The readback verifies the agreed location, duration, owner, scope, and dependent admission time before circulation.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. 30

Planner: "The test lasts 30 minutes."

The interval from 09:20 to 09:50 is thirty minutes.

2. 10

Coordinator: "The buffer before doors is 10 minutes."

Ten minutes separate the 09:50 finish from 10:00 admission.

3. Jo

Planner: "The named task owner is Jo."

The brief explicitly assigns responsibility to audio lead Jo.

4. acknowledgement

Coordinator: "After circulation, collect team acknowledgement."

Sending the schedule alone does not confirm the affected teams received it.

07 Briefing and language checks

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What is the current operational status?

C. Departure is on hold under the operator's plan.

The operator's hold is active; no restart, route, or cancellation is confirmed.

2. What should the group do now in this case?

B. Remain in the designated indoor lounge under the current plan.

The supplied local plan keeps the group in its designated indoor waiting location.

3. Who makes the operational decision?

D. Operations lead Ben

The brief assigns the decision to Ben and does not give Camila departure-clearance authority.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which announcement is accurate?

D. Departure remains on hold; the next operator update is at 09:30.

The announcement preserves the active hold and correctly labels the scheduled communication.

2. What should Camila do if guests demand an immediate departure?

A. Repeat the active instruction and refer the decision through the operator's process.

Guest pressure does not give the agent authority to override the active operational hold.

3. Which statement about cancellation is supported?

A. It has not been confirmed.

The brief distinguishes the current hold from an undecided cancellation.

4. Which financial statement fits the facts?

B. Refund eligibility and any remedy still require confirmation.

No refund decision or alternative arrangement has been approved in the case.

07 Conversation answers

Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. departure hold. Turn 2. The departure hold is the active restriction on leaving, so guests should not interpret the update time as permission to board.

2. travel disruption. Turn 4. Travel disruption describes the effect on the guest's plans without implying that a restart or remedy is already confirmed.

3. operational clearance. Turn 6. Operational clearance must come through the authorized operator process; a change in appearance or an improvised route does not provide it.

4. route assessment. Turn 8. The route assessment concerns whether and how the excursion can operate; no route outcome has yet been confirmed.

5. status update. Turn 10. The status update must be passed on even if it only confirms that the existing hold continues.

6. refund eligibility. Turn 12. Refund eligibility depends on the applicable conditions and decision; the case does not establish an approved refund.

7. rebooking. Turn 14. Rebooking changes the reservation and would require a confirmed option and the guest's agreement, not an automatic assumption.

8. indoor waiting area. Turn 16. The designated indoor waiting area is the location specified by the current local plan, keeping guests available for the authorized update.

9. all-clear. Turn 18. An all-clear would require authorized instructions ending the restriction; none has been issued merely because an update is scheduled.

10. communication chain. Turn 20. The communication chain carries the operations lead's authorized status through the tour desk to the guests without inventing an intermediate decision.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. departure

Guest: "Does eleven mean departure?"

The guest is asking about leaving, which has not been authorized.

2. update

Agent: "No; eleven is the next update."

The scheduled time refers only to the operator's communication.

3. lounge

Guest: "We should remain in the designated indoor lounge."

The current local plan keeps the group in that location.

4. hold

Agent: "Correct; the operational hold remains active."

No authorized decision has ended the restriction on departure.

08 Briefing and language checks

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What does Ms Rahman want before 14:00 today?

A. No routine room entry

Her stated preference concerns routine entry before a specific time today.

2. What is the status of afternoon service?

D. Requested but not yet confirmed

The afternoon team has not confirmed a slot, so the request remains pending.

3. What is known about later days?

C. No preference has been stated.

The brief explicitly limits the stated preference to today, not the entire stay.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which note is accurate?

D. No routine entry before 14:00 today; later service requested, slot pending.

The correct note preserves the guest's stated scope and the unconfirmed afternoon availability.

2. Which question avoids stereotyping?

B. Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

The neutral question asks about the individual's service choice rather than a presumed group trait.

3. What needs confirmation before promising afternoon service?

A. An available slot from the afternoon team

The requested time depends on staffing availability that has not yet been checked.

4. Which statement about future days is supported?

B. Their service preference remains unstated.

The guest has only specified today's preference, so later days cannot be inferred.

08 Conversation answers

Cultural Expectations and Service Style

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. privacy. Turn 2. Privacy concerns the guest's request not to be interrupted before two today, not a whole-stay cancellation.

2. afternoon slot. Turn 4. An afternoon slot is the requested later housekeeping allocation; the team has not yet confirmed it.

3. whole stay. Turn 6. The whole stay covers all three nights, whereas the guest has only stated today's timing preference.

4. assumption. Turn 8. An assumption substitutes an unverified group-based belief for this particular guest's stated request.

5. preference. Turn 10. The preference is the individual's choice for today, not a permanent choice determined by nationality.

6. housekeeping note. Turn 12. The housekeeping note carries the practical request to the team and must not imply cancellation of all service.

7. routine service. Turn 14. Routine service means ordinary housekeeping, distinct from entry governed by a separate urgent-situation procedure.

8. confirmation. Turn 16. Confirmation establishes the arrangement after availability is checked; entering a request does not provide it.

9. time window. Turn 18. The time window is the period for service; tomorrow's period has not been requested or agreed.

10. factual. Turn 20. Factual describes a note limited to the stated service request, without cultural explanations or invented future preferences.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 15:00

Agent: "The no-entry boundary is before 15:00 today."

The guest supplied fifteen hundred as today's routine-entry boundary.

2. availability

Guest: "Later service is subject to availability."

The team has not yet confirmed that a suitable later slot exists.

3. unstated

Agent: "Tomorrow's preference remains unstated."

No request has been supplied for the following day.

4. stereotype

Guest: "Please record my individual request without a cultural stereotype."

A nationality-based generalization is not evidence of this guest's service preference.

08

09 Conversation answers

The banking app still shows the hotel hold

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. authorization hold. Turn 2. An authorization hold reserves funds or credit temporarily; its pending display is not proof of a second completed payment.

2. itemized folio. Turn 6. The itemized folio lists the room, tax, and parking charges, allowing the guest to reconcile the \$280 total.

3. settled payment. Turn 10. The settled payment is the completed \$280 checkout transaction in the supplied record, not the sum of a posted payment and pending authorization.

4. release request. Turn 12. The release request is the hotel's instruction concerning unused authorization; it does not confirm when the issuer will update available funds or its display.

5. card issuer. Turn 16. The card issuer maintains the card account and can check how the pending authorization affects it; the hotel cannot promise its processing time.

6. available balance. Turn 20. The available balance reflects what the guest can currently use; it can be affected by a hold even when only one payment has settled.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. 180

Guest: "The final itemized bill is 180 dollars."

The supplied folio and posted payment both total one hundred eighty dollars.

2. pending

Agent: "The separate authorization is still labeled pending."

The banking display identifies the authorization as pending, not another posted payment.

3. refund

Guest: "The forty-dollar difference is not automatically a cash refund."

An unused authorization is released rather than refunded as though it were a completed charge.

4. timing

Agent: "The issuer must confirm the release timing."

The hotel has submitted the request but cannot guarantee the issuer's processing time.

Background reading: [Hilton: payment and authorization-hold explanations](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

10 Conversation answers

Accessible describes features, not one standard room

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

- 1. specific features.** Turn 2. Specific features identify what this guest needs; a general accessible label does not establish the bed or bathing arrangement.
- 2. roll-in shower.** Turn 6. The roll-in shower is the verified bathing feature in Room C; a tub with grab bars is not the requested substitute.
- 3. layout.** Turn 10. The layout shows the arrangement of the bathroom features, helping the guest assess suitability without the agent asking for a diagnosis.
- 4. access needs.** Turn 12. Access needs concern the practical features the guest requires, not a presumed limitation based on a broad disability label.
- 5. reservation.** Turn 16. The reservation is the actual booking, distinct from an availability discussion; it will be completed after the requested details and the guest's decision.
- 6. bed configuration.** Turn 20. The bed configuration is two separate queen beds in Room C, which must be preserved together with the requested shower features.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

- 1. 3**
Agent: "The verified feature match is Room 3."
Only Room 3 combines both the requested bed arrangement and shower type.
- 2. combination**
Guest: "Two beds with a tub are not an equivalent combination."
Room 2 meets the bed requirement but fails the separately stated shower requirement.
- 3. route**
Agent: "The remaining information concerns the route."
The brief identifies route information as the detail still requiring verification.
- 4. reservation**
Guest: "Availability alone does not complete my reservation."
The guest has not yet decided or completed a booking in this scenario.

10

Background reading: [U.S. Department of Justice: lodging reservations and accessible features](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

Room and tax to the organizer, extras to the guest

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

1. master account. Turn 2. The master account is the organizer's group billing account; the agreement permits room and tax there, not every guest charge.

2. individual folio. Turn 6. The individual folio should carry the guest's \$20 parking and \$30 breakfast charges, totaling \$50 in this supplied example.

3. routing instructions. Turn 10. Routing instructions define which charge categories go to which account; existing postings also need checking rather than assuming an edit moves them correctly.

4. audit trail. Turn 12. The audit trail records the original postings and authorized transfers, so the corrected payer split remains explainable without deleting charges.

5. billing dispute. Turn 16. A billing dispute records disagreement about who should pay or what is due; it should be reviewed without presenting unverified approval as fact.

6. charge transfer. Turn 20. The charge transfer moves the \$50 extras to the proper unpaid guest folio while preserving the \$380 total and the recorded history.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. 264

Coordinator: "The organizer pays 264 dollars."

Two room nights total \$240 and two tax amounts total \$24, producing \$264.

2. 18

Cashier: "The guest pays 18 dollars."

The supplied parking total belongs to the guest under the stated agreement.

3. 282

Coordinator: "The combined bill remains 282 dollars."

Adding the organizer's \$264 and the guest's \$18 preserves the \$282 total.

4. refund

Cashier: "Changing the unpaid allocation is not a refund."

No payment has settled, so correcting the payer allocation does not return money already paid.

11

Background reading: [Oracle OPERA Cloud: reservation routing instructions](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Guest Arrival and Front-Desk Escalation

Acknowledge the impact: I understand that you planned around arriving at noon.

Separate confirmation: It does not confirm that a room is ready at noon.

Offer a place to wait: You are welcome to use the lobby seating.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Complaint Handling and Online Reviews

Recognize the concern: Thank you for raising your concern about the noise.

Protect the booking: Please do not post your booking information publicly.

Request relevant evidence: Let us review the incident log and relevant records.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Reservations, Overbooking, and Walks

State the problem directly: Your booked king-room type is unavailable tonight.

Describe the on-site option: We have a twin room here with two separate beds.

Explain approved costs: We will cover the room-price difference and the transfer.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Revenue Management and Pricing

Clarify the headline: Which measure do we mean by improved?

Give the second result: Night B sold 60 rooms for \$7,200.

Use points correctly: Occupancy fell by 20 percentage points.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Housekeeping, Maintenance, and Turnover

Name the exact room: I am checking the release status for Room 417.

State the missing authority: The duty manager's final release is not recorded.

Avoid an invented deadline: I do not have a confirmed repair completion time.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Events, Banquets, and Run of Show

Expose the assumption: We both assumed the other team had arranged it.

Name the owner: Vera has accepted responsibility for the soundcheck.

State the buffer: That leaves fifteen minutes between soundcheck and admission.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Tour Operations and Traveler Safety

State the hold first: Departure is currently on hold.

Avoid a route promise: No route has been confirmed.

Reject an informal all-clear: I cannot clear departure based on how the sky looks.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Cultural Expectations and Service Style

Ask about the service: Would you prefer service later today or no service today?

Keep availability honest: I still need to check an afternoon slot.

Use the guest's words: The note should describe the service and timing you requested.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acknowledgement give a courteous acknowledgement	14
acknowledgement obtain team acknowledgement	51
afternoon slot verify an afternoon slot	68
all-clear avoid an assumed all-clear	60
alternative accommodation verify alternative accommodation	23
approved allowance state the approved allowance	24
arrival instructions provide arrival instructions	24
arrival time confirm the arrival time	5
assumed preference question an assumed preference	69
audio lead confirm the audio lead	50
authorization limit respect an authorization limit	6
availability check complete an availability check	24
average daily rate (ADR) calculate average daily rate	32
banquet event order (BEO) reconcile the banquet event order	51
bed configuration explain the bed configuration	23
booking amendment confirm a booking amendment	24
booking pace track booking pace	32
booking reference protect the booking reference	14
buffer time preserve buffer time	51
cancellation notice issue a cancellation notice	60
case record update the case record	15
change control follow event change control	51
channel mix examine the channel mix	33
check-in window clarify the check-in window	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

claim ticket issue a claim ticket	6
clarifying question ask a clarifying question	69
communication chain follow the communication chain	60
communication style adapt communication style	69
competitive set review the competitive set	33
complaint handler assign a complaint handler	15
complimentary offer a complimentary service	6
conditional offer reject an improper conditional offer	15
confirmation number verify the confirmation number	24
contingency arrangement verify contingency arrangements	60
cue call the cue	50
cue sheet verify the cue sheet	50
defect report submit a defect report	42
defensive tone remove a defensive tone	14
demand assess room demand	32
departure clearance distinguish departure clearance	60
departure hold maintain the departure hold	59
designated shelter use the designated shelter	59
distribution cost include distribution costs	33
do-not-disturb request record a do-not-disturb request	68
door-lock fault report a door-lock fault	41
doors open confirm doors-open time	50
duration of stay distinguish the duration of stay	68
duty manager consult the duty manager	5

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

early arrival note an early arrival	5
early check-in request early check-in	5
emergency access distinguish emergency access	69
engineering department contact the engineering department	42
equivalent feature check equivalent features	24
escalation explain the escalation	6
excursion coordinate a coastal excursion	59
expectation gap acknowledge an expectation gap	6
factual check complete a factual check	15
follow-through ensure reliable follow-through	6
forecast occupancy revise forecast occupancy	33
form of address ask the preferred form of address	69
front desk contact the front desk	5
function sheet check the function sheet	51
goodwill gesture consider a goodwill gesture	15
gross operating profit distinguish gross operating profit	33
group accountability maintain group accountability	60
guaranteed access distinguish guaranteed access	5
guest consent obtain guest consent	24
guest feedback respond to guest feedback	14
guest relations refer to guest relations	5
guest-required feature verify guest-required features	42
handover contact identify the handover contact	24
handover log update the handover log	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

headcount confirm the headcount	51
housekeeping clearance record housekeeping clearance	41
incident log consult the incident log	15
incidental expense clarify incidental expenses	24
individual variation recognize individual variation	69
indoor waiting area identify the indoor waiting area	59
inspection record verify the inspection record	41
interruption avoid an unnecessary interruption	69
itinerary revise the itinerary	59
king room confirm a king room	23
language preference check language preference	69
lightning safety plan follow the lightning safety plan	59
load-in coordinate the load-in	51
load-out confirm the load-out	51
lobby use the lobby seating	6
luggage storage offer luggage storage	6
maintenance clearance obtain maintenance clearance	41
market segment compare market segments	33
meeting point confirm the meeting point	60
microphone check complete a microphone check	50
net room revenue define net room revenue	33
neutral wording use neutral wording	69
noise complaint investigate a noise complaint	14
non-room revenue separate non-room revenue	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

occupancy rate report the occupancy rate	32
occupied room identify an occupied room	42
off-site arrange an off-site room	23
on-site offer an on-site alternative	23
on-the-books review on-the-books revenue	33
open repair track an open repair	41
operational clearance await operational clearance	59
operations lead consult the operations lead	59
opt in opt in to service	68
opt out opt out for today	68
out of order confirm an out-of-order status	41
out of service check the out-of-service code	41
overbooking manage an overbooking	23
passenger manifest check the passenger manifest	60
personal attack avoid personal attacks	14
personal space respect personal space	69
pickup report booking pickup	33
playback feed test the playback feed	50
preference note update the preference note	68
price elasticity assess price elasticity	33
private channel use the approved private channel	14
property management system (PMS) update the PMS	41
public reply publish a public reply	14
published contact details use published contact details	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

rate difference cover the rate difference	24
rate premium explain the rate premium	33
rate strategy evaluate the rate strategy	32
readback request a status readback	42
rebooking check rebooking options	60
receiving property contact the receiving property	23
refund eligibility verify refund eligibility	60
release authorization verify release authorization	41
release hold maintain the release hold	42
relocation explain the relocation	23
reputational risk reduce reputational risk	15
reservation confirmation review the reservation confirmation	5
resolution status report the resolution status	15
response template adapt a response template	15
restart decision communicate the restart decision	60
return to service confirm return to service	42
revenue management review revenue management	32
revenue per available room (RevPAR) compare revenue per available room	32
revenue trade-off explain a revenue trade-off	33
review incentive avoid a review incentive	15
reviewer acknowledge the reviewer	14
room assignment confirm a room assignment	5
room booking verify the room booking	50
room discrepancy resolve a room discrepancy	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

room layout	approve the room layout	51
room night	measure demand in room nights	32
room release	await room release	6
room revenue	distinguish room revenue	32
room status	reconcile room status	41
room turnover	coordinate room turnover	41
room type	verify the room type	23
room-ready time	verify the room-ready time	6
room-type mismatch	resolve a room-type mismatch	23
rooms available	state rooms available	32
rooms sold	verify rooms sold	32
route assessment	await the route assessment	59
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run of show	update the run of show	50
schedule version	circulate the schedule version	51
scope of request	confirm the scope of request	68
service commitment	document the service commitment	24
service confirmation	await service confirmation	69
service frequency	clarify service frequency	68
service lapse	verify a service lapse	14
service preference	clarify a service preference	68
service recovery	coordinate service recovery	6
service remedy	authorize a service remedy	15
service window	confirm the service window	68

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

setup window	protect the setup window	50
soundcheck	coordinate the soundcheck	50
special request	record a special request	5
stage manager	brief the stage manager	50
status reconciliation	complete status reconciliation	42
status update	provide a status update	6
stay dates	verify stay dates privately	14
stayover service	coordinate stayover service	68
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task owner	name the task owner	51
technical rehearsal	schedule a technical rehearsal	50
thunderstorm	respond to a thunderstorm	59
tour operator	contact the tour operator	59
transfer	arrange the approved transfer	24
travel disruption	explain the travel disruption	60
twin room	offer a twin room	23
unverified allegation	distinguish an unverified allegation	15
vacant clean	distinguish vacant clean	42
vacant dirty	report vacant dirty	42
walk	arrange a guest walk	23
weather advisory	monitor weather advisories	59
work order	update a work order	41

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] CoStar / STR. What Is Hotel Benchmarking?

[Open the original source](#)

Background definitions for occupancy, average daily rate, and revenue per available room. The two-day pricing comparison and all figures are original teaching examples. Checked 30 September 2026.

[2] Google Business Profile Help. Tips to Get More Reviews.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on professional public replies, privacy, and the prohibition on incentives to change or remove reviews. The complaint dialogue and property policy are fictional. Checked 30 September 2026.

[3] National Weather Service. Lightning Safety and Outdoor Sports Activities.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on planned weather decisions and designated responsibility for outdoor activities. The tour case supplies a fictional local hold and guest-update process, not a complete safety plan. Checked 30 September 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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